THE STABLECOIN

The pulse of digital money. The infrastructure of tomorrow.

Insights into the capital flows, partnerships, regulation and infrastructure shaping the stablecoin economy. This edition covers September 2026.

FEATURE ARTICLE

FIVE WAYS TO MOVE A STABLECOIN

PLATFORM GUIDE 2026

Five stablecoin payment platforms compared, from checkout gateways to enterprise orchestration.

$2.19B

Thirty-seven transactions in a single month — venture rounds, acquisitions, credit facilities and a twenty-one bank alliance. The full ledger begins on page 31.

MAIN NEWS OF THE MONTH

REPORTS & WHITEPAPERS

THE ARTICLE PLATFORMS

DEALS OF THE MONTH

DATA HUB IN NUMBERS

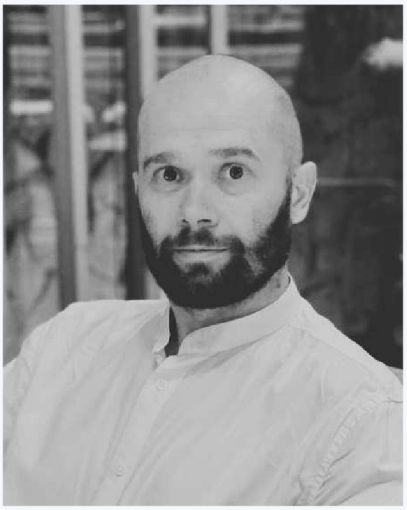
EDUCATIONAL ARTICLES

EVENT CALENDAR

FROM THE EDITOR

THIS ISSUE

A monthly review of the companies, banks, regulators and payment networks building the infrastructure of digital money. This edition covers September 2026.



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FROM THE EDITOR

SEPTEMBER WAS THE MONTH MONEY STOPPED KEEPING OFFICE HOURS.



For decades, money moved on the schedule of the banks that carried it. In September, that schedule started to look like a choice rather than a law.

The largest lenders stopped watching. Twenty-one US firms, Bank of America, Citi and Goldman Sachs among them, are planning a joint dollar stablecoin for 2027. U.S. Bank sent a live cross-border payment in its own token, HSBC named its Hong Kong coin RedCoin, and UK banks settled real customer payments in tokenised sterling. Singapore's three largest banks did the same on Swift's ledger.

Issuers, meanwhile, started to look like networks. Circle launched Arc with Visa, BlackRock, DTCC and Mastercard as validators, and Open Standard issued a dollar stablecoin backed by Visa, Stripe and Mastercard. The companies that once only moved money are now underwriting it.

Public money answered with rules and alternatives. The Federal Reserve proposed a rulebook for bank and non-bank issuers. The ECB launched Pontes to settle tokenised assets in central-bank money and asked Brussels to loosen MiCA's reserve requirements. The BIS argued that tokenised deposits will matter more than stablecoins; Tether replied that fully reserved tokens are the stronger form of money.

Underneath, the always-on layer simply kept working. Cards settled on weekends, payroll and creator payouts reached nearly every country, Binance and Bybit traded currencies and equity options through Saturday, and African and Gulf corridors filled in from both directions.

Even the month's disagreements — deposits against stablecoins, Frankfurt against Washington, a coin per bank against one coin for the industry — are arguments about ownership, not direction. Every one of them assumes the clock is already gone.

The debate is no longer whether money should run around the clock. It is who will own the rails it runs on.

THE MONTH BANKING HOURS STOPPED MATTERING

BANKS ISSUING THEIR OWN DOLLARS, AN ISSUER LAUNCHING ITS OWN CHAIN, CARDS THAT SETTLE ON WEEKENDS — SEPTEMBER READ AS ONE BRIEFING ON MONEY THAT NEVER CLOSES.

21

US financial firms planning a joint dollar stablecoin for H1 2027

160+

stablecoin-linked card programmes now running on Visa

$20B

settled by Visa in stablecoins — now a validator on Circle's Arc

100+

applications live on Arc at mainnet launch

For most of its history, money has kept office hours. Payments queued at the close of business, waited out weekends and crossed borders on the timetable of the slowest correspondent in the chain. In September that timetable started to look optional.

The month's announcements came from every direction — the largest US lenders, central banks in Frankfurt and Washington, card networks, payroll platforms and consumer wallets — and they shared one assumption: settlement should run whenever the customer does.

Wall Street Builds Its Own Dollar

The biggest institutional signal came from the United States. Twenty-one financial firms, among them Bank of America, Citi and Goldman Sachs, plan to form a joint company and launch a US dollar stablecoin by the first half of 2027. The group is more than double the ten-bank effort that surfaced last October — evidence that staying out now looks riskier than joining.



Twenty-one US financial firms, including Bank of America, Citi and Goldman Sachs, plan a joint dollar stablecoin for 2027.

U.S. Bank went further and moved real money. The Minneapolis lender completed a live cross-border payment with its USBDC stablecoin on Stellar and is studying the token for treasury, liquidity management and collateral, though no commercial rollout date has been set.

The custody and plumbing layer moved with the banks. Citi will use Coinbase Prime to hold and trade digital assets for institutional clients. Anchorage Digital wired LayerZero into its custody and settlement stack so clients can move stablecoins across chains, and Volante Technologies and Circle will let banks process USDC through payment infrastructure they already run.

Regional banking found its own route. Fiserv's digital asset platform went live with its first institutional clients; Bank of North Dakota's Roughrider Coin, the first use case, moves money between more than 90 banks and credit unions on Solana. Coinbase and Moov will bring stablecoin payments to over 1,000 community banks and credit unions, with Coinbase supplying regulated infrastructure and Moov embedding acceptance, merchant settlement and real-time funding.

Newcomers want the same seat. OpenReserve raised a $25 million seed round led by a16z crypto and won preliminary approval for an OCC bank charter. SoFi and Payward tied banking to crypto markets: Payward joins the SoFi Exchange Network, Kraken lists SoFiUSD, and SoFi taps Kraken Prime for liquidity.

The direction is the same at every size of bank. The largest are building a coin of their own, mid-sized lenders are plugging into custody partners, and the smallest are getting stablecoins through the core-processing vendors they already pay. Very few US banks will reach 2027 without some route to a dollar token.

London and Hong Kong Go Live

Outside the US, banks moved from pilots to customers. UK lenders completed the first live customer transactions using tokenised sterling deposits, settling real retail payments on a shared ledger alongside traditional rails. Visa and Lloyds finished live trials of stablecoin settlement between acquirers and issuers inside existing card flows, and ClearToken won Bank of England approval to clear tokenised securities on a live basis within the Digital Securities Sandbox.

HSBC gave its forthcoming Hong Kong stablecoin a name — HSBC RedCoin — and a plan: a phased rollout starting with person-to-person and person-to-merchant payments. The bank's survey found 74 percent of local customers recognise at least one stablecoin use case, and 62 percent named regulatory clarity as the biggest boost to confidence.



HSBC names its Hong Kong stablecoin RedCoin, starting with P2P and merchant payments.

In Singapore, DBS, OCBC and UOB completed the first live blockchain-based Singapore dollar transactions on Swift's ledger using tokenised deposits, showing interbank payments can run outside traditional processing windows. Hong Kong is heading the same way: under Project EnsembleTX, the HKMA plans a wholesale CBDC for interbank payments by year-end to enable 24-hour settlement of tokenised assets and deposits.

Korea Opens the Door

South Korea drew the most foreign interest. Hana Card signed a three-way MOU with Tether and Hana Bank to explore linking stablecoins with Korean financial services, as Hana Financial Group expands through BitGo Korea and newly approved VASP registration. MoonPay launched MoonPay Korea as its Asian hub, planning work with Finger, Woori Bank, KB Financial Group and KakaoBank on distribution, remittances and digital-asset services. Beatoz and Danal began a pilot of stablecoin acceptance at the point of sale.

THE BANKS DID NOT WAIT FOR THE DEBATE TO END — THEY TOOK IT TO THEIR CUSTOMERS.

Across London, Hong Kong, Singapore and Seoul the pattern repeats. Each bank puts its own name on the token, keeps the customer relationship and treats the shared ledger as a back-office upgrade rather than a new business. Customers see a faster payment; the bank keeps the deposit.

That is a different bet from the US consortium, which pools issuance across competitors to build one dollar token for everyone. Over the next year the two models — a coin per bank, or one coin for the industry — will be tested side by side, and the answer will shape how much of the market the big issuers keep.

Deposits Versus Dollars

Which token banks carry became the month's sharpest argument. The Bank for International Settlements published research expecting tokenised deposits to play a larger role than stablecoins in future payments, backing deposit tokens for settlement while flagging interoperability gaps and financial-stability risks.

Tether's Paolo Ardoino answered bluntly, calling stablecoins a higher form of money than fractional-reserve products. With USDT now above $183 billion in market capitalisation, he argued, fully reserved tokens are exposing weak points in traditional deposit structures. Both sides describe the same future — programmable money on shared ledgers — and disagree only about whose balance sheet sits underneath.

Central Banks Draw the Lines

Washington moved from statute to rulebook. The Federal Reserve proposed rules for banks and non-banks issuing dollar stablecoins, setting requirements for reserve backing, redemption rights and risk management across issuers.



The Federal Reserve proposes reserve, redemption and risk rules for bank and non-bank stablecoin issuers.

Frankfurt offered an alternative and a correction. The ECB launched Pontes, connecting distributed-ledger platforms to TARGET Services so tokenised wholesale assets can settle in central-bank money — pitched explicitly as an option to stablecoins for institutions. It also urged the EU to scrap MiCA's requirement that 60 percent of stablecoin reserves sit in bank deposits, warning the concentration itself could threaten stability, and invited merchants into its digital euro pilot.

Not every central bank is doubling down. Caribbean authorities are retreating from CBDCs after weak uptake of DCash and Jam-Dex: Barbados launched the BiMPay fast payment system in June, and the ECCB is pivoting to instant rails. India took the opposite path, with HDFC Bank rolling out five Digital Rupee use cases — card-reward redemption, gift vouchers, corporate allowances, BHIM integration and offline tap-to-pay on flights.

The divergence matters for anyone building on top. A firm settling tokenised bonds in Frankfurt may soon use central-bank money through Pontes, while its US subsidiary holds a Fed-supervised stablecoin and its Caribbean partners route through instant payment rails instead of a CBDC. Interoperability, the BIS warning, is not a technical footnote — it is the practical cost of every jurisdiction choosing differently.

For now the choices look complementary rather than competing. Central banks are keeping wholesale settlement and the final layer of trust, and leaving retail reach to banks and regulated issuers.

THE STATE IS CHOOSING ITS SEAT — ISSUER, SUPERVISOR OR OPERATOR OF THE RAILS.

Circle Builds a Chain of Its Own

Circle replied with infrastructure. Arc, its open Layer 1 blockchain built for financial markets and agentic activity, reached mainnet with native USDC, more than 100 applications and a validator set that reads like a payments index. Gas is paid in USDC; on the public testnet the average transaction cost was below one cent.

Visa's role says the most. Having settled $20 billion in stablecoins, it joined Arc as a founding validator alongside BlackRock, DTCC and Mastercard — a shift from using blockchain to operating it.



Circle's Arc goes live with native USDC and validators including Visa, BlackRock, DTCC and Mastercard.

The ecosystem showed up on day one. Paribu enabled USDC deposits and withdrawals over Arc in Türkiye. Wirex One launched publicly on the network, offering stablecoin private banking — cashback, yield and transfers — to mass-affluent users after 20,000 joined its closed beta. Maple made syrupUSDC available from launch, giving builders access to institutional lending yield from roughly $1 billion in overcollateralised loans. Arc Studio, an AI coding agent, turns plain-language prompts into full-stack onchain apps testable across nine chains.

Circle also turned Arc into a credit venue. Eligible institutional Circle Mint customers can now deposit bitcoin, mint cirBTC and borrow USDC through third-party lending markets on Arc or Ethereum, starting with Morpho and with Aave expected next.

AN ISSUER THAT OWNS THE CHAIN, THE PAYOUT RAILS AND THE DEVELOPER TOOLS IS NO LONGER JUST AN ISSUER.

Beyond the chain, Circle agreed to acquire Singapore's Tazapay, adding local payout rails and reach into more than 100 markets. CCTP now moves EURC natively between chains, starting with Ethereum and Base, and a wider partnership with OKX deepens USDC liquidity across spot, margin and futures.

For rivals, Arc raises the cost of standing still. An issuer that controls the chain can set fees, prioritise its own settlement and bundle lending, payouts and developer tools into one offer — the kind of vertical integration card networks spent decades building. Whether partners accept that dependence is the question Arc's first year will answer.

The Card Becomes the Wallet

At the checkout, stablecoins arrive disguised as cards. Visa said more than 160 stablecoin-linked card programmes now run on its network, with payment volume up nearly 200 percent year on year, and it is pairing VisaNet settlement data with onchain lending so those programmes can extend credit. With Reap, it is taking stablecoin credit cards to more than 100 markets, pushing into EMEA and Africa; Reap has already processed $20 billion in stablecoin settlement across 175 million merchant locations.

MoneyGram went live on Rain with a card that spends stable dollar balances at more than 175 million Visa locations; the company is on course to route about $3 billion a year of FX through stablecoins. In Colombia it launched a Stellar-powered Visa card for spending USDC, with physical cards and regional expansion next. Rain also added KRW1, the first Korean won stablecoin, issued by BDACS, opening the door to won-denominated card programmes.

THE CUSTOMER SEES A CARD. THE SETTLEMENT UNDERNEATH NEVER SLEEPS.

The plumbing behind the cards consolidated. BVNK and Marqeta partnered so that crypto-native and traditional companies can embed USD stablecoins in wallets and cards with 24/7 settlement — aimed at the 77 percent of crypto users who would open a stablecoin wallet through their main bank or fintech app. Thredd brought stablecoin settlement into its issuing and processing platform through Velocity.

Wirex went live on Tempo as a settlement layer for enterprise card programmes after reaching $1 billion in annualised onchain volume in 131 days. Bybit Pay and Mesh let Bybit's 80 million users spend across Mesh-powered platforms without withdrawing or converting. Lossdog, founded by thinkorswim creators Tom Sosnoff and Scott Sheridan, unveiled Lucky Dog Coin as the first token on ZeroHash's Onchain Issuance Platform, built for card-based spending.

Why the Card Wins First

Cards solve the problem that held stablecoins back for years: acceptance. Merchants keep their terminals and acquirers keep their contracts, while the issuer funds each purchase from a dollar balance that can be topped up at midnight on a Sunday. The trials at Lloyds and the programmes on Visa show the networks are now willing to let stablecoins reach the settlement leg itself, not just the cardholder's wallet.

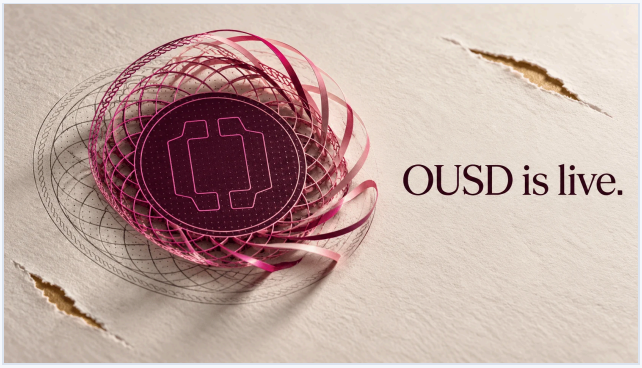
For issuers the shift is economic as much as technical. Settling in stablecoins removes pre-funding across time zones and shortens the window in which money sits idle between authorisation and clearing. That is why the infrastructure firms — Marqeta, Thredd, Rain and Reap — are moving first: the margin they recover is theirs to keep.

It also explains the geography. Programmes are growing fastest where local cards are expensive to issue and dollar accounts hard to open — Latin America, Africa and Southeast Asia — which is exactly where Reap, Rain and MoneyGram aimed their September launches.

Wirex's run to $1 billion in 131 days and MoneyGram's $3 billion FX target suggest the volumes are no longer experimental. The open question is credit: Visa's onchain lending and Reap's stablecoin credit cards test whether a dollar balance can also back a revolving line, which is where card economics have always been made.

Everyone Issues

The networks that once only moved money are now backing it. Open Standard issued a dollar stablecoin supported by Visa, Stripe and Mastercard, aiming at an open, interoperable standard for global payments. It also partnered with Infinia to carry Open USD into emerging markets, connecting local clearing grids such as Pix, SPEI and Transferencias 3.0.



Open Standard issues a dollar stablecoin backed by Visa, Stripe and Mastercard.

Regulated issuance spread across currencies. AllUnity launched USDAU, a MiCA-regulated dollar stablecoin with segregated reserves, on Ethereum, Solana, Base, Tempo, Arc and Polygon — dollar liquidity inside Europe's perimeter. Tetra Trust launched CADD, Canada's first Canadian dollar stablecoin from a regulated financial institution, live on Base, Ethereum and Tempo.

Issuance is also becoming a product feature. PayPal introduced PYUSDx with M0 and MoonPay, letting any business issue a custom token backed by PYUSD; the first, from Saturn, Concrete and Cap, bring more than $100 million in processed volume. MoonPay secured an EMI licence from the Dutch central bank, the first Netherlands-based firm to pair MiCA CASP authorisation with an EMI licence and open-loop stablecoin capability.

Self-Custody Goes Mainstream

Consumer apps are converging on one design: a dollar balance, a card and yield, held in the user's own wallet. World launched World Money in more than 150 countries, combining balances, transfers, trading and Morpho-powered earn, with Stripe, Bridge and Lead Bank handling US funding. Ethena Pay opened a beta on Avalanche in 48 countries, holding USDe with up to 6 percent APY and up to 10 percent cashback.

Nu partnered with Sygnum on Nu Global, a multi-currency account built on USDC and EURC. Stable.com joined Polygon's Open Money Stack so users can fund bank transfers straight from USDT or PYUSD in self-custody wallets, and Mercuryo and Tangem dropped fees on USDC purchases for Stellar users.

WHEN THE NETWORKS THAT MOVE MONEY START BACKING IT, ISSUANCE BECOMES A FEATURE, NOT A BUSINESS.

Every coin launched this month arrived attached to a distribution channel. Open Standard has the card networks, PYUSDx has PayPal's merchants, and CADD and USDAU have regulatory approval in markets where compliant dollar or local-currency liquidity was scarce. A token without such a channel is becoming hard to justify.

The consumer apps complete the loop. Once a balance can be earned, spent and sent from a single self-custody wallet, the bank account becomes one funding option among several rather than the default home for a salary.

Treasury Without Office Hours

For businesses, always-on settlement is most concrete in payouts. Nium launched stablecoin funding: companies fund in USDC and pay out in local currency, converted instantly and delivered to more than 190 countries in seconds. Rain extended payouts to over 80 countries in 50 currencies from a single stablecoin balance, with locked quotes and live status. WasabiCard widened bulk payroll and creator payouts for livestreaming businesses across more than 200 countries and regions.

KAST opened a 24/7 business platform that sends and receives stablecoin payments regardless of banking hours. MassPay turned its payout network around with MassPay Collect, built for inbound flows. Modern Treasury launched non-custodial stablecoin wallets with Turnkey, offering embedded wallets in the US and more than 90 countries through one API alongside its fiat accounts.

Access to the coin itself is opening up. Freemarket and Axiym launched LIQUI-DT, giving businesses round-the-clock access to primary-market USDT from Tether; in audited trials clients minted or burned more than $300 million through the regulated network.

PAYROLL ON A SUNDAY IS NO LONGER AN EXCEPTION — IT IS THE PRODUCT.

Platforms Consolidate

Unlimit folded its Global Accounts business into Stable.com, uniting traditional and digital money on one platform. BVNK added native Stellar support across all 130+ of its markets, giving customers another low-cost settlement route through a single API on a network that processed $55.6 billion in payments in 2025.

Exchanges are repositioning as infrastructure. Luno pivoted to crypto as a service after acquiring GTXN in September, letting banks and asset managers mint stablecoins and move money across borders on its rails. Utila's Licensed Partner Network lets fintechs without their own money transmission or CASP licences operate through licensed partners; Fipto, CoinGate, Balance and Surus are early members across the EU, US and Canada.

The Cut-Off Time Disappears

What links these launches is the end of the cut-off time. A finance team that funds in USDC can release payroll on a public holiday, pay a supplier in another time zone within the hour and track every transfer in real time — operations that used to wait for two banks to be open at once.

The consolidation is a sign of maturity. Buyers want one contract covering accounts, cards, collections and stablecoin rails, not five vendors stitched together, and the platforms are reorganising to sell exactly that.

Collection is following payouts. MassPay Collect, PhotonPay's local accounts and Kora's One Rail start from the same insight: a company that can pay in stablecoins will soon expect to be paid in them, and the platform that handles both directions owns the treasury relationship.

The remaining friction sits at the edges — converting into local currency, satisfying auditors and booking the entries in an ERP. That is where the next round of products, from Modern Treasury's wallets to Utila's shared licences, is concentrated, and where the vendors that win the back office will lock in the front.

The Corridors Widen

Fipto joined the Circle Payments Network as an originating institution, carrying USDC payouts from Europe to seven markets in Latin America and Asia that settle on domestic rails such as PIX and SPEI. Infinia added Brazil's BRLA, Mexico's MXNB and the UK's TGBP to its Programmable Money OS, with Colombian and Argentine coins next. Banking Circle extended its work with OSL to stablecoin-to-fiat settlement in six currencies.

Interoperability kept pace. Chainlink launched CCIP 2.0 with faster finality, lower costs and wider chain support, and will explore blockchain cross-border payments with Bottomline for more than 600 banking clients.

Africa Builds Both Directions

African rails now run in and out. PhotonPay opened local collection accounts in Nigeria and Ghana, so global businesses can collect naira and cedi through compliant channels. Kora added USDT and USDC to its One Rail, letting merchants collect, hold, convert and settle in stablecoins alongside fiat. Caliza and Yala partnered so African businesses can pay international suppliers in stablecoins across several corridors.

Capacity is flowing outward too. Yellow Card took its stablecoin rails to North America through Alkepay in Canada, and Tether released open-source translation models for 19 African and 9 European languages that run offline on everyday devices.

The Gulf Writes Its Own Playbook

Mastercard's Dreamonomics research ranked UAE SMEs among global leaders in digital asset payments: one in seven accepts crypto and 10 percent already pay business expenses in stablecoins. Noah's Shah Ramezani argued the Gulf built around payments rather than speculation, with clear regulatory ownership, AE Coin used for government fees and around $500 billion in GCC assets projected to move onchain by 2030. He expects cross-border B2B stablecoin payments to grow from about $13 billion this year to more than $500 billion by 2030.

Fasset plans to become the first platform to list DDSC, the dirham-backed stablecoin, pending VARA approval, and the UAE told businesses to convert crypto transaction values to dirhams at the rate on the date of supply for VAT. Further east, OrbitX brought stablecoin QR payments to Vietnam and the Philippines, settling in local fiat.

THE NEWEST CORRIDORS RUN SOUTH TO SOUTH AND GULF TO WORLD — NOT THROUGH NEW YORK.

Local stablecoins are doing what dollar coins could not: settling in the currency a merchant actually prices in. Brazilian reais, Mexican pesos, sterling, dirhams and won now have tokens of their own, and the firms connecting them to domestic rails such as Pix and SPEI are turning stablecoins from a dollar export into a local payment layer.

None of these corridors depends on a correspondent bank in New York or London. Value moves between two local rails, with a stablecoin carrying it across the gap for seconds rather than days. For exporters in Lagos, São Paulo or Dubai, that turns a cross-border payment from a cost centre into something closer to a domestic transfer.

The constraint now is regulatory reach, not technology. Every new corridor still needs licences at both ends, which is why partnerships rather than greenfield launches dominated the month.

Markets That Never Close

Trading venues are using stablecoins to erase the weekend. Binance launched 24/7 FX perpetuals with up to 100x leverage, starting with a USDT-settled USD/BRL contract that switches from external price feeds to orderbook data when FX markets shut. Bybit introduced USDT-settled FX perpetuals on EUR/USD, GBP/USD and USD/JPY, then the first 24/7 TradFi options, on SpaceX and Nvidia, without a separate brokerage account.

EDGE Markets launched with ZeroHash for instant stablecoin account funding, and Zoth's zVaults turn a single stablecoin deposit into tokenised US stocks on Base for users without a US broker. Bloomberg added a stablecoin dashboard to the Terminal, powered by Allium onchain data.

Credit Follows Settlement

Bullish extended a $100 million debt facility to USD.AI for lending against GPUs, and plans to list sUSDai across several pairs. Tether and Fasanara launched a $400 million fund for stablecoin-enabled private credit. Maple posted $1.47 million in August revenue, its fourth straight monthly rise, spending a tenth on SYRUP buybacks.

Yield products multiplied. KuCoin introduced KCUSD at a 4 percent base rate for USDT, USDC and USDG. Paxos Labs launched PAXGy, a PAX Gold token designed to grow as reserves earn returns from institutional gold leasing, via OKX Gold Earn and X Layer. Coinbase's Brian Armstrong called stablecoin payments a core growth engine for the company's next phase.

Scrutiny Rises With Scale

Size brought attention. The US Department of Justice seized $84.2 million tied to Capstone, and Tether confirmed funds were stuck at EQIBank, saying exposure was under 0.034 percent of group assets and it had no knowledge of the alleged conduct.

RedotPay chose transparency as preparation: it completed a financial audit and AML review by Big Four firms ahead of a planned US IPO at a valuation above $5 billion, with 8.5 million users, and added two state lending licences to its US portfolio.

THE WEEKEND WAS THE LAST MARKET HOLIDAY. STABLECOINS ARE CLOSING IT.

The appeal is collateral that never sleeps. A trader posting USDT can hold a currency or equity position through Saturday without waiting for a bank transfer to clear on Monday, and venues can price the gap from their own orderbooks. Regulators will ask how those weekend prices are formed; traders have already answered with volume.

Credit and scrutiny are two sides of the same growth. As stablecoin balances reach the size of mid-sized banks, they attract lending markets — and, with them, the auditors, law enforcement and public-market disclosure that come with holding other people's money.

Yield, meanwhile, is drifting from crypto-native protocols toward real-world assets — GPUs, private credit, gold leases and institutional loans. sUSDai, the Tether–Fasanara fund and PAXGy all promise returns tied to something outside the chain, which makes the quality of that collateral, not the smart contract, the main risk to watch.

Coinbase's pivot puts the largest US exchange on the same path, betting that payments rather than trading fees will define its next decade.

Rules Catch Up

Regulators elsewhere worked on implementation. MAS opened consultation on Payment Services Act amendments defining how issuers qualify as MAS-regulated and the safeguards they owe on value stability and user protection. Uzbekistan began a pilot of government-backed HUMO stablecoin payments pegged to the som, with more than 20 businesses preparing to join over up to three years.

eCurrency unveiled an offline CBDC after an African demonstration, and a Swiss stablecoin project entered testing with SIX and TWINT. In the US, Noah's Shah Ramezani argued the country's position as crypto hub is secure even if the CLARITY Act stalls, because bank and payments activity has already made the direction irreversible.

What September Showed

Put the month side by side and it stops looking like separate news. Banks are issuing their own dollars, card networks are validating blockchains, payroll runs on weekends and an issuer now operates its own chain.

Even the disagreements point one way. Deposits or stablecoins, public or private money, Frankfurt's Pontes or Washington's rulebook — each is an argument about who owns the always-on layer, not about whether it will exist.

The winners of that contest will not necessarily be the issuers with the largest supply. They will be the institutions whose customers never notice the switch — whose payroll, card and treasury flows simply stop waiting.

What to Watch in October

01 **The Fed's rulebook** — how banks and non-banks respond to reserve, redemption and risk requirements.

02 **MiCA's 60 percent rule** — whether Brussels follows the ECB and loosens the bank-deposit requirement for reserves.

03 **The 21-bank coin** — the legal structure and governance of the US consortium.

04 **Arc's first volumes** — how much real payment activity Visa, Mastercard and the launch partners bring onchain.

05 **RedCoin's rollout** — the first person-to-person and merchant payments in Hong Kong.

None of these is a headline on its own. Together they will show whether September was a peak of announcements or the start of a routine — the point at which always-on settlement stops being news and becomes infrastructure nobody remarks on.

That is the quiet test for every launch in this issue. The most successful will be the ones readers stop hearing about, because the money simply arrives.

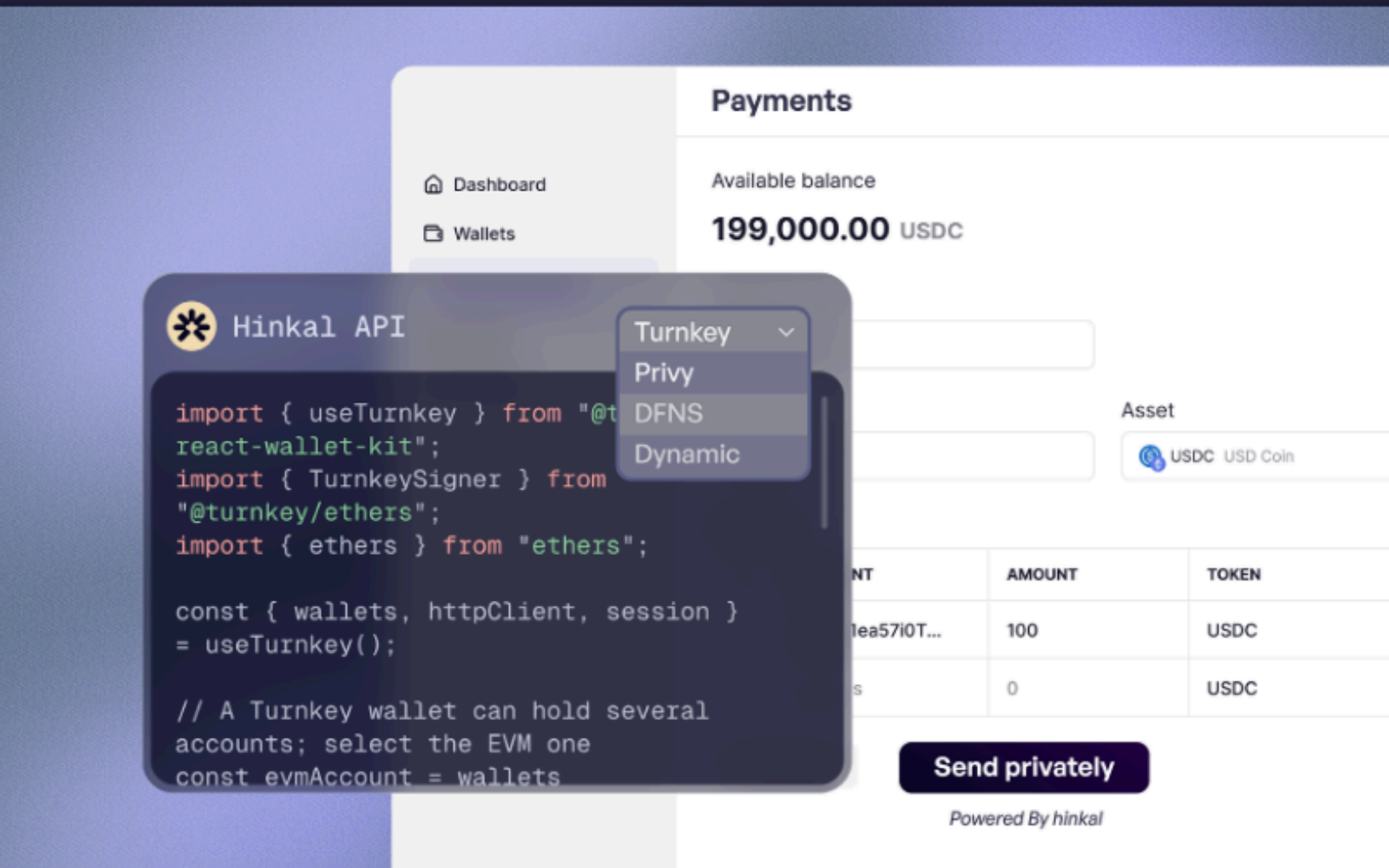
MONEY HAS STOPPED KEEPING OFFICE HOURS.

hinkal API & SDK

Privacy built into your stack

Add private balances, deposits, withdrawals, payments, and swaps to your product - without changing your custody model, user experience, or tech architecture

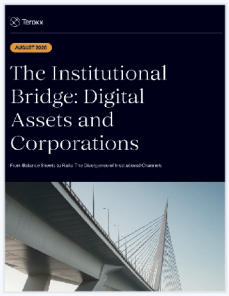
polygon · MPCVault · AllScale · THE VAULT · peso · Borderless.xyz



REPORTS & WHITEPAPERS

THIRTY-NINE DOCUMENTS WORTH THE READING TIME THIS MONTH — FROM CENTRAL-BANK FIELD STUDIES AND LAW-FACULTY WORKING PAPERS TO ISSUER FILINGS, TRADE-FINANCE ARCHITECTURE AND A BOOK FOR THE WEEKEND.

THE ARGUMENTS ARE SETTLED. THE PLUMBING IS NOT.



TEROXX · AUGUST 2026

THE INSTITUTIONAL BRIDGE: DIGITAL ASSETS AND CORPORATIONS

From balance sheets to rails. Teroxx tracks how corporate engagement with digital assets has split into two channels — treasuries holding crypto as a reserve asset, and companies wiring stablecoins into payments and settlement — and argues the two are now diverging.

linkedin.com/company/teroxx



RIPPLE · 2026 EDITION

THE FUNCTIONAL EVOLUTION OF DIGITAL ASSETS

From speculation to infrastructure. Ripple sets tokenized deposits and stablecoins against treasury, settlement, collateral and liquidity workflows, projects an $18.9 trillion tokenized-asset market by 2033, and makes the case that custody is the layer the rest depends on.

ripple.com · report



CGAP · JUNE 2026

STABLECOINS IN HUMANITARIAN CASH TRANSFERS

A 62-page reading deck for aid agencies and social-protection programmes. It assesses what stablecoins can and cannot do across the two hard legs of humanitarian payments — the cross-border transfer and last-mile delivery in fragile and conflict-affected states.

cgap.org · reading deck



STABLECON × ARTEMIS · Q3 2026

THE STATE OF STABLES: Q3 REPORT

The quarterly data read from Stablecon and Artemis, with Latin America on the cover: supply, transfer volumes and on-chain activity for the quarter, and where stablecoin usage is concentrating across chains, issuers and regional corridors.

artemis · report request



INT. JOURNAL OF FINANCIAL STUDIES · MAY 2026

DESIGNING RETAIL CBDCs: TRADE-OFFS BETWEEN SECURITY, PRIVACY AND STABILITY

A systematic review of 140 papers that proposes a CBDC trilemma: privacy, financial stability and compliance cannot all be maximised at once. The literature converges on tiered, two-tier designs — a "zone of feasible design" — and leaves nine research gaps open.

ideas.repec.org · IJFS 14(5) 122



VERIAN FOR THE RESERVE BANK OF AUSTRALIA · AUGUST 2026

PUBLIC CONSULTATION: UNMET PAYMENT NEEDS AND DIGITAL MONEY

The independent write-up of the RBA's public consultation on digital money. Verian sorts what households, businesses and industry said they cannot do with today's payments — the evidence base the RBA will lean on when weighing stablecoins, tokenized deposits and a wholesale CBDC.

linkedin.com · report

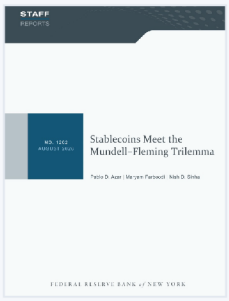


CIGI PAPERS NO. 360 · AUGUST 2026

DISTRIBUTED LEDGER TECHNOLOGY AND THE FUTURE OF PAYMENTS IN CANADA

Tracey Black on why Canada modernises payments by coordination rather than disruption — regulators, big banks and shared infrastructure moving together — and a predictive read of how DLT, tokenization and programmable settlement are likely to land in that system.

cigionline.org · paper and PDF



FEDERAL RESERVE BANK OF NEW YORK · AUGUST 2026

STABLECOINS MEET THE MUNDELL–FLEMING TRILEMMA

Staff Report 1202. Linking geotagged ENS names to wallet flows, the authors find USD stablecoin inflows jump in crisis-country wallets during crisis weeks — and model how that erodes capital controls, making a fixed peg with independent monetary policy harder to hold.

newyorkfed.org · Staff Report 1202



DIGITAL ASSET GLOBAL ADVISORS · AUGUST 2026

THE NEXT GENERATION OF CROSS-BORDER PAYMENTS

Corporate treasury research on how treasurers are evaluating and implementing stablecoins: the friction and compounding cost of today's cross-border rails, what leading companies are already doing, and the questions a treasury team should settle before a pilot.

daga.io



AL-MABROOK FINANCIAL · Q3 2026

THE CASH LEG: STABLECOINS, DEPOSITS AND CUSTODY AS THE RULEBOOK TAKES EFFECT

A board-level briefing timed to the US statute taking effect on 18 January 2027. It reads Europe's closed authorisation window, Hong Kong's two licences and the Bank of England's softer stance, and sets out six decisions a board should take before the law is live.

linkedin.com · briefing



EUI ROBERT SCHUMAN CENTRE · SEPTEMBER 2026

EQUIVALENT TO EQUIVALENCE: OPENNESS AND RECIPROCITY FOR STABLECOINS

Policy Brief 2026/20. MiCA's missing third-country route does not remove cross-border risk — it pushes it into multi-issuance structures. Andrew Whitworth argues for firm-specific conditional access, backed by supervisory colleges and shared reserve data, over slow jurisdiction-wide equivalence.

cadmus.eui.eu · policy brief



DEUTSCHE BANK RESEARCH · SEPTEMBER 2026

ASSET TOKENIZATION 101: THE NEXT PHASE OF FINANCIAL INFRASTRUCTURE

Marion Laboure and Camilla Siazon with a primer for allocators: what gets tokenized, which assets move first, and where tokenized money and real-world assets meet existing market plumbing.

dbresearch.com · PDF

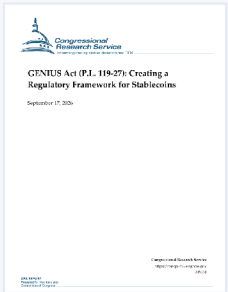


SAPERE AUDE CONSORTIUM · AUGUST 2026

INSTANT EVERYTHING: STABLECOINS AND THE ROAD TO REAL-TIME FINANCE

An opinion snapshot written by four undergraduates: a plain-language walk from paper money to stablecoins, why settlement still takes days in an instant world, and what fiat-backed versus algorithmic designs mean for users.

sapereaudeconsortium.com

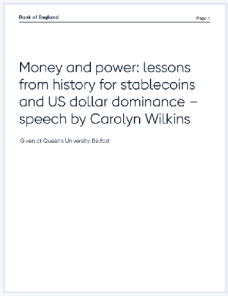


CONGRESSIONAL RESEARCH SERVICE · 17 SEPTEMBER 2026

GENIUS ACT (P.L. 119-27): CREATING A REGULATORY FRAMEWORK FOR STABLECOINS

CRS Report R49351, written for Members and committees of Congress. The neutral reference on what the statute requires of issuers, who supervises them, and what is left to implementing rules before it takes effect.

congress.gov · R49351

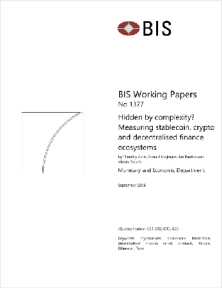


BANK OF ENGLAND · SEPTEMBER 2026

MONEY AND POWER: LESSONS FROM HISTORY FOR STABLECOINS AND DOLLAR DOMINANCE

Carolyn Wilkins at Queen's University Belfast reads stablecoins through the history of reserve currencies — what dollar-denominated tokens could do to monetary sovereignty outside the US, and what it means for sterling.

bankofengland.co.uk · speech

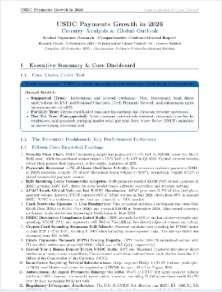


BANK FOR INTERNATIONAL SETTLEMENTS · SEPTEMBER 2026

HIDDEN BY COMPLEXITY? MEASURING STABLECOIN, CRYPTO AND DEFI ECOSYSTEMS

BIS Working Paper 1377. Aerts, Heijmans, Paulick and Vuletic build a method for mapping on-chain ecosystems across Bitcoin, Ethereum and Tron — a measurement toolkit for supervisors who need to see where stablecoins actually sit.

bis.org · Working Paper 1377

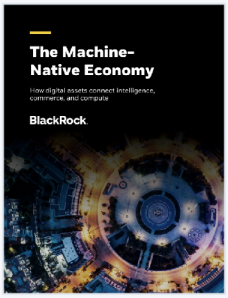


GLOBAL PAYMENTS RESEARCH · SEPTEMBER 2026

USDC PAYMENTS GROWTH IN 2026: COUNTRY ANALYSIS AND GLOBAL OUTLOOK

An evidence-graded test of one thesis — that USDC is becoming a settlement layer. Verdict: true for institutional and network settlement, partly true for card spend and treasury, not yet true for consumer checkout and retail remittances.

linkedin.com · report

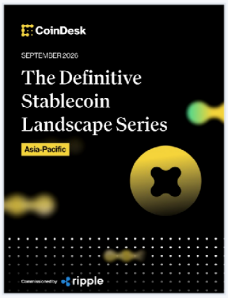


BLACKROCK · 2026

THE MACHINE-NATIVE ECONOMY

How digital assets connect intelligence, commerce and compute. BlackRock's case that AI agents will need programmable money to transact with each other — and that stablecoins and tokenized funds are the rails being laid for it.

blackrock.com · PDF

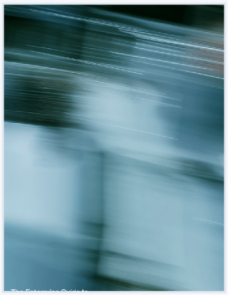


COINDESK FOR RIPPLE · SEPTEMBER 2026

THE DEFINITIVE STABLECOIN LANDSCAPE: ASIA-PACIFIC

The APAC instalment of the landscape series: market by market, who issues, who regulates and where stablecoins are already moving money — from licensing regimes in Hong Kong and Singapore to corridor usage across the region.

ripple.com · report

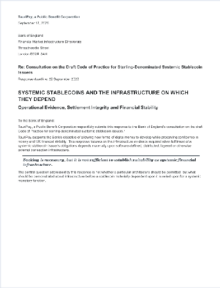


TEMPO · 2026

THE ENTERPRISE GUIDE TO STABLECOIN EARN PROGRAMS

A practical guide for companies offering yield on stablecoin balances: how earn programmes are structured, where the return comes from, and the legal and risk questions to settle before switching one on.

tempo.xyz · report



TAURIPAY · 17 SEPTEMBER 2026

SYSTEMIC STABLECOINS AND THE INFRASTRUCTURE ON WHICH THEY DEPEND

A response to the Bank of England's draft code for sterling systemic issuers. Its line: backing is necessary but not sufficient — what must be proven is the software, ledger and settlement infrastructure an issuer relies on.

linkedin.com · response



UNIVERSITY OF ZURICH BLOCKCHAIN CENTER · SEPTEMBER 2026

RECURSIVE LEVERAGE IN YIELD-BEARING STABLECOINS

A master project presentation on how yield-bearing stablecoins get looped — deposited, borrowed against and redeposited — and how much hidden leverage that stacks up across DeFi.

linkedin.com · presentation



WORLD TRADE ORGANIZATION · 2026

STABLECOINS AND WORLD TRADE

Emerging role, opportunities and challenges. The WTO looks at stablecoins as a trade-finance and settlement tool — what they could cut from the cost of cross-border commerce, and what they raise for developing economies.

wto.org · publication



SOLANA FOUNDATION · AUGUST 2026

HOW STABLECOINS ON SOLANA ARE RESHAPING REMITTANCES

An evolution of money movement: the Foundation sets out how remittance companies are using stablecoins on Solana to cut cost and settlement time on consumer corridors, with operator case studies.

solana.com · report



REDCOMPASS LABS · 2026

ARE BANKS ACTUALLY READY FOR DIGITAL MONEY?

A payments consultancy's readiness check: what stablecoins, tokenized deposits and digital currencies demand from a bank's core systems, compliance and operations — and where most banks fall short today.

redcompasslabs.com · report request



STABLECOIN INSIDER · Q3 2026

MONEY MOVES EAST: THE STABLECOIN CORRIDORS IN ASIA

A corridor-by-corridor map of stablecoin flows across Asia, produced with Capital Layer, Movantis, Reap, Stabo and Triple-A — who is moving money where, and on which rails.

tally.so · report request



TEMPO RESEARCH · 2026

LAUNCHING STABLECOIN PAYMENT PRODUCTS

A practical guide for banks: the product, compliance and settlement decisions behind launching stablecoin payments, from choosing a model to running it alongside existing rails.

tempo.xyz · report



SSRN · 23 AUGUST 2026

TOKENIZING CENTRAL BANK MONEY ON PUBLIC BLOCKCHAINS

Ulrich Bindseil and B. Duve revisit sovereign money on open infrastructure. Issuing directly on public chains is likely cheaper than a proprietary CBDC and reduces vendor lock-in; the paper weighs the risks and the policy goals it could serve.

ssrn.com · paper

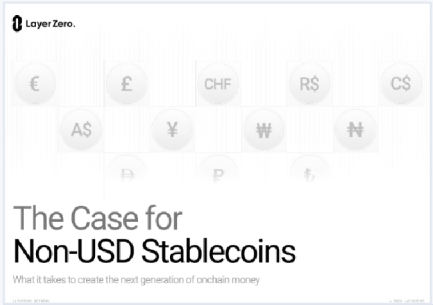


STABLECOIN BEAT · AUGUST 2026

STABLECOIN MARKET REPORT

The monthly market read: size and trend, top movers, concentration and peg stability, supply by chain, GENIUS- and MiCA-compliant tokens, yield-bearing coins and the macro backdrop.

linkedin.com · report



LAYERZERO · 2026

THE CASE FOR NON-USD STABLECOINS

What it takes to create the next generation of onchain money. LayerZero argues the market needs euro, sterling, yen, real and other local-currency coins — and that liquidity and cross-chain reach decide which survive.

layerzero.network



SINGAPORE FINTECH ASSOCIATION · SEPTEMBER 2026

THE AUTONOMOUS ECONOMY

With StraitsX and Visa: how AI agents, stablecoins and payment infrastructure are shaping the next generation of commerce, and what Singapore's regulated stablecoin rails offer agent-driven payments.

straitsx.com · whitepaper

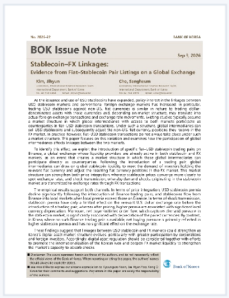


CEPR · SEPTEMBER 2026

STABLECOINS WITHOUT BORDERS: MULTI-COUNTRY ISSUANCE AND DOLLAR-RUN RISKS IN EUROPE

Policy Insight 151. Martino, Monnet and Perotti show how one token issued under US and EU regimes creates redemption arbitrage — in stress, holders run to the stronger EU redemption rights, importing dollar-run risk into Europe.

cepr.org · Policy Insight 151



BANK OF KOREA · 3 SEPTEMBER 2026

STABLECOIN–FX LINKAGES: EVIDENCE FROM FIAT–STABLECOIN PAIR LISTINGS

BOK Issue Note 2026-22. When Binance lists a fiat–USD stablecoin pair, premia fall and shocks pass into the FX market. Where no pair exists, as in Korea, buying pressure stays inside the stablecoin premium.

bok.or.kr · Issue Note



OPENFX · Q2 2026

BUILDING MODERN RAILS FOR EMERGING MARKETS

Why cross-border payments are broken for much of the world, corridor by corridor — from Lagos to Manila to Dhaka — and how OpenFX plans to fix them with stablecoin-based settlement.

openfx.com · report



UTILA · 2026

STABLECOIN 2.0: OWN THE STACK

An institutional primer to modular stablecoin infrastructure: why issuers and platforms should own issuance, custody and wallet layers rather than rent them, and how that choice moves margins.

utila.io · guide

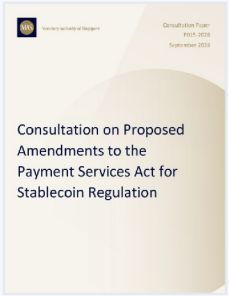


MIDDLE EAST STABLECOIN ASSOCIATION · SEPTEMBER 2026

PROOF OF RESERVE FOR STABLECOIN ISSUERS

A framework from the DIFC-based association for transparency, risk mitigation and regulatory alignment: what a credible reserve attestation should show, how often, and to whom.

mesaofficial.com · insights

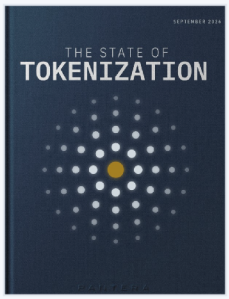


MONETARY AUTHORITY OF SINGAPORE · SEPTEMBER 2026

CONSULTATION ON AMENDMENTS TO THE PAYMENT SERVICES ACT FOR STABLECOINS

Consultation Paper P015-2026. MAS proposes moving its single-currency stablecoin framework into law under the Payment Services Act — the document every issuer targeting Singapore needs to answer.

mas.gov.sg · consultation

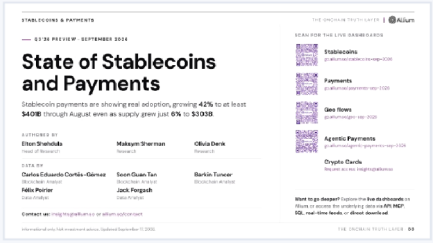


PANTERA CAPITAL · SEPTEMBER 2026

THE STATE OF TOKENIZATION

Pantera's survey of the tokenized-asset market: which asset classes are moving on-chain, who is issuing, and why stablecoins remain the cash leg every tokenized market depends on.

panteracapital.com · PDF



ALLIUM · SEPTEMBER 2026

STATE OF STABLECOINS AND PAYMENTS: Q3 PREVIEW

Stablecoin payments grew 42% to at least $401 billion through August while supply rose just 6% to $303 billion. Live dashboards cover payments, geo flows, agentic payments and crypto cards.

allium.so · report

FIVE WAYS TO MOVE A STABLECOIN

A side-by-side look at the platforms businesses use to send, collect and settle digital dollars in 2026 — and the job each one is really built for.

BASED ON REPORTING BY TECHBULLION

Picking a stablecoin provider is less about the token and more about everything wrapped around it: who pays, who checks, and who reconciles.

Stablecoins have travelled from crypto exchanges into accounts payable. Treasurers no longer ask whether digital dollars work — they ask which platform should carry them. The honest answer depends on whether a company needs a checkout button, a vault, or a complete payment engine.

How the Platforms Were Judged

Each provider was scored on six dimensions:

01 The payment rails on offer and the flows they can handle

02 Reach across borders and the speed of settlement

03 Breadth of regulatory and compliance coverage

04 Links into banks, wallets and treasury software

05 Readiness for enterprise-scale volumes

06 Range of stablecoins, from USDC to multi-currency

Enterprise scenarios carried the most weight — supplier payments, treasury movements and large payout runs — because that is where corporate adoption is picking up fastest.

TABLE 1 · AT A GLANCE

PLATFORM	STRONGEST FIT	CORE ADVANTAGE	INDICATIVE COST	SCORE
Notabene Flow	Enterprise B2B payments	Orchestration with compliance built in	Per transaction	**9.5** /10
Fireblocks	Treasury & custody	Institutional-grade asset security	Bespoke	**9.0** /10
Coinbase	Exchange-linked payments	Fiat on- and off-ramps	Usage-based	**8.5** /10
BVNK	Fintech products	API-first infrastructure	Bespoke	**8.5** /10
BitPay	Merchant checkout	Long-standing crypto gateway	~1%	**8.0** /10

Scores and pricing as assessed by the original publication. Costs are indicative; bespoke means negotiated per client.

01 Notabene Flow

9.5 /10

BUILT FOR: ENTERPRISE & CROSS-BORDER B2B · COST: PER TRANSACTION

Notabene Flow pitches itself as an open orchestration layer for stablecoin payments. Companies use it to move USDC and other tokens across borders while compliance checks run inside the payment itself, not as a separate step bolted on afterwards. What separates it from most crypto payment tools is support for structured flows — pull payments, recurring billing and invoice-led collection — that mirror how businesses already bill one another.

Toolkit: pull and invoice-driven payments · near-instant settlement across chains · built-in Travel Rule tooling · automated multi-currency reconciliation · connections to existing PSPs, wallets and banks.

WHERE IT SHINES

+ Follows real B2B processes
+ Cuts cross-border costs by more than 70%
+ Removes manual reconciliation
+ No migration off existing networks

WHERE IT FALLS SHORT

– A young category, still little known
– Full value needs integration work

Bottom line: **the strongest choice for enterprises that need cross-border stablecoin payments to be compliant and scalable from the start.**

02 Fireblocks

9.0 /10

BUILT FOR: TREASURY & DIGITAL ASSET CUSTODY · COST: NEGOTIATED ENTERPRISE CONTRACTS

Fireblocks began as security infrastructure and is still, above all, a vault. Institutions holding large balances of crypto and stablecoins depend on it to store and move assets safely, with payment rails added on top of that core.

Toolkit: MPC-based custody · treasury and liquidity management · stablecoin payment rails · links to exchanges and banking partners.

WHERE IT SHINES

+ Robust security architecture
+ Deep trust among institutions
+ Well suited to treasury desks

WHERE IT FALLS SHORT

– Not a full orchestration engine
– Few native merchant workflows

Bottom line: **the pick when protecting and managing assets matters more than designing payment flows.**

03 Coinbase Payments — 8.5/10

BUILT FOR: EXCHANGE-LINKED PAYMENTS WITH FIAT CONVERSION · COST: VARIES WITH VOLUME

Coinbase stretches its exchange into payments, letting businesses send and accept USDC and switch to and from fiat without leaving the ecosystem. **Toolkit:** on- and off-ramps · USDC payments · exchange liquidity · developer APIs.

WHERE IT SHINES

+ Recognised brand, deep liquidity
+ Fast onboarding
+ Natural fit for existing clients

WHERE IT FALLS SHORT

– A closed ecosystem
– Less adaptable to complex enterprise processes

Bottom line: most useful for companies already working inside Coinbase.

04 BVNK — 8.5/10

BUILT FOR: FINTECHS BUILDING GLOBAL PAYMENT PRODUCTS · COST: BESPOKE

BVNK sells stablecoin rails to fintechs and payment providers, and its API is the product. It blends fiat and crypto movement so partners can embed payouts and collections in their own apps. **Toolkit:** stablecoin payments and payouts · fiat and crypto rails · embedded finance · global coverage.

WHERE IT SHINES

+ Developer-friendly API
+ Tuned for fintech use cases
+ Handles global flows

WHERE IT FALLS SHORT

– Compliance orchestration is not the focus
– Fewer advanced workflow features

Bottom line: a solid base for fintechs turning stablecoins into a product feature.

05 BitPay — 8.0/10

BUILT FOR: ACCEPTING CRYPTO AT CHECKOUT · COST: AROUND 1% PER TRANSACTION

One of the sector's veterans, BitPay has spent years helping merchants take crypto — stablecoins included — and settle in the currency they prefer. **Toolkit:** crypto checkout · stablecoin acceptance · merchant tools · flexible settlement.

WHERE IT SHINES

+ Simple for merchants to plug in
+ Long track record
+ Many coins supported

WHERE IT FALLS SHORT

– Thin enterprise toolkit
– Not designed for complex B2B flows

Bottom line: right for retailers who simply want customers to pay in crypto.

Feature by Feature

The scorecard below lays the five providers against the same eight capabilities. Read across a row to see who leads on a given job; read down a column to see where a platform runs out of road.

TABLE 2 · CAPABILITY MATRIX

CAPABILITY	NOTABENE FLOW	FIREBLOCKS	COINBASE	BVNK	BITPAY
Payment orchestration	● **Advanced**	○ Limited	○ Basic	● Moderate	○ Basic
Cross-border payments	● **Strong**	● Moderate	● Moderate	● **Strong**	○ Limited
Stablecoins supported	● Multiple	● Multiple	● USDC-led	● Multiple	● Multiple
Compliance	● **Native**	● Partial	● Partial	● Partial	○ Limited
Integration depth	● **High**	● **High**	● Medium	● **High**	● Medium
Treasury support	● **Strong**	● **Strong**	● Moderate	● Moderate	○ Limited
Payment flows	● **Full**	○ Limited	○ Basic	● Moderate	○ Basic
Enterprise readiness	● **High**	● **High**	● Medium	● **High**	○ Low

● Leading ● Adequate ○ Thin

THE TOKEN IS THE EASY PART. THE WORKFLOW AROUND IT DECIDES THE PLATFORM.

The grid makes the trade-offs plain. Custody specialists and exchange platforms score well on security and liquidity, then thin out as soon as payments need logic — approvals, recurring pulls, automated reconciliation.

Checkout gateways are the mirror image: quick to switch on, hard to stretch into supplier payments or treasury. Only the orchestration and fintech-infrastructure players stay strong across cross-border reach and integration.

So Which One?

There is no single winner — only the right tool for a given job. Match the platform to the problem:

Accepting crypto at checkout	**BitPay**
Safeguarding a digital asset treasury	**Fireblocks**
Payments that live inside an exchange	**Coinbase**
Building a fintech product on stablecoin rails	**BVNK**
Compliant cross-border enterprise payments with structured workflows	**Notabene Flow**

For the last and most demanding category, the original assessment ranks Notabene Flow first among 2026 platforms: it brings payment infrastructure, compliance and network reach into one system — which is what most companies moving money across borders actually need.

FIVE QUESTIONS, BRIEFLY

What does a stablecoin payment platform do?

It lets a business send, collect and manage money in fiat-pegged tokens such as USDC, using blockchain networks in place of conventional banking rails.

Why would a business use one?

Cheaper transfers, faster settlement, better use of liquidity, and payments that can carry programmable rules.

Will stablecoins replace banks?

Not on their own. Fiat conversion, liquidity and treasury still lean on banks; stablecoins are becoming a rail that runs alongside them.

How does a cross-border stablecoin transfer work?

Value moves on-chain directly between the two parties, skipping much of the correspondent banking chain and settling in close to real time.

How should a company choose a provider?

Start with the job — checkout, treasury or enterprise orchestration — then test integration depth, compliance coverage and the payment flows on offer.

SOURCE · Adapted and rewritten from “Best Stablecoin Payments Platforms in 2026: Compare the Top Solutions”, TechBullion. Ratings and assessments are the original publication’s.

WHERE THE MONEY WENT

FUNDING ROUNDS, STRATEGIC STAKES, ACQUISITIONS AND CREDIT FACILITIES — CAPITAL MOVING INTO SETTLEMENT RAILS, MARKET INFRASTRUCTURE AND PREDICTION MARKETS.

ONE ROUND WAS REPORTED AT $1B. THE OTHER THIRTY-EIGHT BUILT THE RAILS.

INVESTMENT & M&A REVIEW

ONE HEADLINE ROUND. THIRTY-EIGHT INFRASTRUCTURE DEALS.

TRANSACTIONS	DISCLOSED CAPITAL	EXCLUDING POLYMARKET
39	**$2.28B**	**$1.28B**
Across four categories	September 2026	38 transactions

September produced **39 disclosed transactions** and roughly **$2.28B** of identified capital across venture, strategic investment, M&A and debt. Almost half of that figure is a single line: Polymarket's reported $1B round, which has not been formally confirmed in full.

Strip it out and the month reads as a build-out. The other twenty-four venture rounds shared about $407M — an average under $17M — for stablecoin settlement, payment orchestration, merchant acceptance, market data and onchain private credit.

M&A carried the most strategic weight. Circle paid approximately **$400M for Tazapay**, MoonPay a reported $60M+ for North Capital, and S&P Global took OpenZeppelin. Six deals, roughly $477M disclosed, all bought licences, distribution or expertise rather than users.

Strategic money came from market operators. Nasdaq put $100M into Kraken parent Payward, Binance put $100M into Circle alongside an expanded five-year USDC distribution partnership, and Robinhood took stakes in Crypto.com and OG.com to push into prediction markets.

Prediction markets ran through the whole month — Polymarket's round, Kalshi's purchase of Oddpool, Robinhood's investments and RWAperp's perpetuals. Debt was the quietest category: two facilities, $153M, both financing operating businesses rather than token positions.

VENTURE CAPITAL · SEPTEMBER 2026

TWENTY-FIVE ROUNDS, ONE OF THEM REPORTED AT $1B.

VENTURE CAPITAL DEALS · $15M AND ABOVE

10 OF 25 DEALS · $1.31B

COMPANY	AMOUNT	ROUND	FOCUS
Polymarket	**$1B**	REPORTED	Onchain prediction-market infrastructure; the complete round has not been formally confirmed.
Félix	**$87M**	SERIES C	USDC-enabled cross-border payments distributed through WhatsApp.
Kaiko	**~$57M**	SERIES B EXT.	Institutional digital-asset data, pricing and indices for tokenized markets.
HIFI	**$37M**	SERIES A	Stablecoin payments and tokenized-capital-markets infrastructure; includes $21.8M disclosed earlier via Form D.
Latitude	**$35M**	SERIES A	Stablecoin payments connected with local banking and settlement rails.
Openreserve	**$25M**	SEED	Blockchain-native banking infrastructure for programmable accounts and tokenized deposits.
Fin.com	**$20M**	SEED	Stablecoin settlement connected to local banking and payment rails.
Limited	**$18.5M**	EXPANDED SEED	Stablecoin-powered accounts, cards, payments and treasury for international businesses.
VerifiedX	**$15M**	FINANCING	Institutional Bitcoin products, custody and market infrastructure.
dtcpay	**~$15M**	SERIES A EXT.	Regulated stablecoin and fiat payment infrastructure for merchants.

Polymarket's reported $1B dominates the table, but the complete round has not been formally confirmed — treat it as reported rather than closed. The next nine rounds total $309.5M.

Payments lead below it: Félix's $87M Series C for USDC remittances over WhatsApp, Latitude's $35M and Fin.com's $20M seed, both wiring stablecoin settlement into local banking rails.

HIFI raised twice in the month — $21.8M disclosed via Form D, then a $37M Series A of which $15.2M was new. The table counts it once, at $37M.

Kaiko's ~$57M extension is the data play: pricing and indices for tokenized markets, sold to the institutions now building them.

VENTURE CAPITAL · CONTINUED

THE MIDDLE OF THE TABLE IS SETTLEMENT PLUMBING.

VENTURE CAPITAL DEALS · UNDER $15M

15 OF 25 DEALS · $97.75M

COMPANY	AMOUNT	ROUND	FOCUS
Atum	**$13.5M**	FUNDING ROUND	Payment orchestration across stablecoins, chains and traditional rails.
Tare	**$13.25M**	SEED	Onchain origination, servicing and securitization for private credit.
Diameter Pay	**$10M**	SERIES A	Institutional dollar accounts, payment rails and stablecoin ramps.
Velocity	**$10M**	SERIES A EXT.	Institutional stablecoin settlement, liquidity and treasury.
Finloop HK	**$10M+**	SERIES A+	Wealth infrastructure across tokenized RWAs, virtual and traditional assets.
MeshWallet	**$10M**	PRIVATE FINANCING	Self-custodial, gasless USDT payment infrastructure on TRON.
Firelight Protocol	**$8M**	SEED	Economic protection infrastructure for DeFi vaults.
Antarctic Exchange	**$7M**	FUNDING ROUND	Institutional onchain trading and liquidity infrastructure.
INFINI	**$6M**	SEED	AI-powered accounts, payments, cards and treasury on stablecoin settlement.
infiniFi	**$3M+**	SEED	Onchain fractional-reserve and stablecoin-yield infrastructure.
Plenti	**$3M**	SEED	Digital-dollar accounts, payments and investing across Latin America.
RWAperp	**$2M**	FUNDING ROUND	Onchain perpetuals on equities, indices, commodities and crypto.
Tenka	**$2M**	PRE-SEED	Asset-backed finance with onchain reporting and secondary liquidity.
TRM Labs	**Undisclosed**	SERIES C EXT.	Blockchain intelligence and financial-crime tools; valued at $2B.
tZERO Group, Inc.	**Undisclosed**	FUNDING ROUND	Regulated issuance, custody, trading and settlement for tokenized securities.

Most rounds fund the layer between stablecoins and traditional rails — Atum, Velocity, MeshWallet, INFINI — while Tare and Tenka bring private credit onchain.

Two undisclosed rounds carry the most weight: TRM Labs at a $2B valuation, and tZERO's regulated stack for tokenized securities.

STRATEGIC INVESTMENT & CONSOLIDATION

CIRCLE TOOK $100M IN — AND PAID $400M OUT.

STRATEGIC INVESTMENTS

6 DEALS · $247.5M DISCLOSED

COMPANY / TRANSACTION	AMOUNT	TYPE	FOCUS
Nasdaq / Kraken	**$100M**	STRATEGIC INVESTMENT	Investment in Kraken parent Payward to expand cooperation across tokenized markets and market infrastructure.
Binance / Circle	**$100M**	STRATEGIC EQUITY	Accompanies an expanded five-year USDC distribution partnership.
Cari Network	**$32.5M**	STRATEGIC ROUND	Bank-backed infrastructure for interoperable tokenized deposits.
NG.CASH	**$15M**	STRATEGIC ROUND	Credit, stablecoin and digital-finance infrastructure for younger consumers in Brazil.
Robinhood / Crypto.com / OG.com	**Undisclosed**	STRATEGIC EQUITY	Investments supporting Robinhood's expansion in prediction markets.
IOSG Ventures / IMMERSVE	**Undisclosed**	STRATEGIC INVESTMENT	Stablecoin payments connecting digital wallets with Mastercard acceptance and fiat settlement.

MERGERS & ACQUISITIONS

6 DEALS · ~$477M DISCLOSED

ACQUIRER / TARGET	AMOUNT	TYPE	FOCUS
Circle / Tazapay	**~$400M**	ACQUISITION	Regulated cross-border payment infrastructure expanding Circle's stablecoin distribution network.
MoonPay / North Capital	**Reported $60M+**	ACQUISITION	Issuance, brokerage, transfer-agency and secondary-market infrastructure for tokenized private securities.
FOMO Pay / Mobula	**$17M**	ACQUISITION	Blockchain data-indexing infrastructure for onchain trading applications.
Kalshi / Oddpool	**Undisclosed**	ACQUISITION · YC P26	Prediction-market trading and market-making infrastructure.
S&P Global / OpenZeppelin	**Undisclosed**	ACQUISITION	Smart-contract security and technology-risk infrastructure for institutional onchain markets.
CoinMarketCap / CoinGlass	**Undisclosed**	ACQUISITION	Crypto-derivatives data: open interest, funding rates, liquidations, options and positioning.

Two $100M cheques set the strategic tone, both from market operators: Nasdaq into Kraken's parent, Binance into Circle. Cari Network's $32.5M funds bank-backed rails for tokenized deposits.

Acquirers bought capability. Tazapay gives Circle regulated cross-border payment licences; North Capital gives MoonPay a tokenized-securities stack; S&P Global, CoinMarketCap and Kalshi bought security, data and trading expertise.

DEBT FINANCING AND THE MONTH IN SUMMARY

TWO CREDIT LINES — AND $2.28B ACROSS FOUR CATEGORIES.

DEBT FINANCING

2 DEALS · $153M DISCLOSED

COMPANY	AMOUNT	TYPE	FOCUS
Félix	**$113M**	CREDIT FACILITY	Financing expansion beyond remittances into additional financial products.
USD.AI	**$40M**	REVOLVING FACILITY	Stablecoin-denominated financing for AI hardware and other income-generating assets.

SEPTEMBER BY CATEGORY

39 DEALS · ~$2.28B

CATEGORY	DISCLOSED	DEALS	SHARE
Venture capital	**$1.41B**	25 DEALS	61.6% of disclosed capital; $407M excluding Polymarket.
M&A	**~$477M**	6 DEALS	20.9% — led by Circle's ~$400M acquisition of Tazapay.
Strategic	**$247.5M**	6 DEALS	10.8% — two $100M stakes in Kraken's parent and Circle.
Debt financing	**$153M**	2 DEALS	6.7% — Félix and USD.AI credit facilities.

Both credit facilities finance operating businesses. Félix's $113M line, alongside its $87M Series C, backs expansion beyond remittances; USD.AI's $40M revolver lends in stablecoins against AI hardware and other income-generating assets.

Taken together, September's 39 transactions describe a market paying for infrastructure: settlement rails and treasury tools at seed and Series A, data and security bought outright, and the largest cheques written by exchanges, market operators and the one prediction market big enough to raise a reported $1B.

STABLECOIN DATA HUB

THE MONTH IN NUMBERS — SUPPLY, VOLUME, LIQUIDITY AND PAYMENT ACTIVITY ACROSS NETWORKS, VENUES AND CARD PROGRAMMES.

SUPPLY TELLS YOU WHO HOLDS THE DOLLARS. VOLUME TELLS YOU WHO USES THEM.

THE MONTH IN FOUR NUMBERS

SUPPLY HELD. TURNOVER COOLED 13.5%.

TOTAL SUPPLY	AVG DAILY VOLUME	AVG DAILY TRANSACTIONS	AVG DAILY ACTIVE ADDRESSES
$316.2B	**$246.4B**	**—**	**5.1M**
+0.4% vs 30D ago	−13.5% vs prev 30D	Not reported by source	−5.0% vs prev 30D

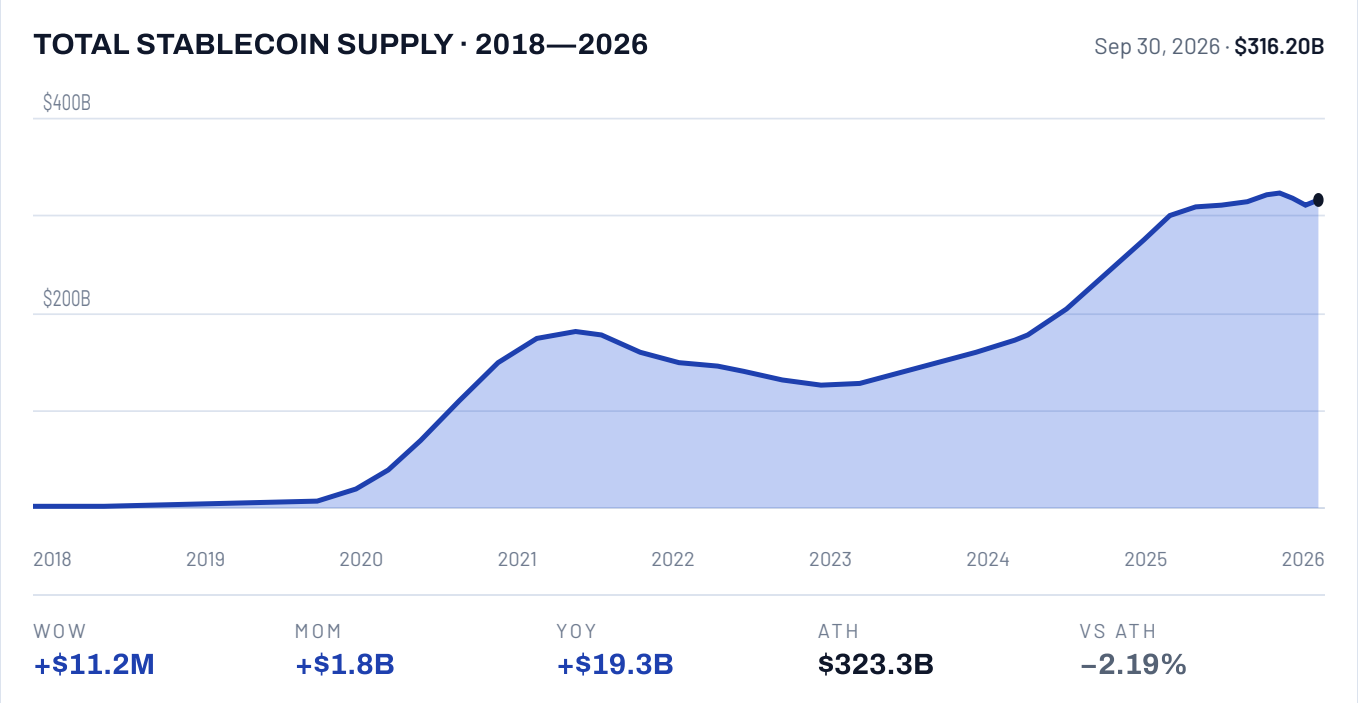


Figure 3. Eight years of supply. The float has now spent most of 2026 inside a $310–323B corridor; September closed $7.1B below the all-time high, having recovered a third of the summer drawdown. Source: Artemis, as of Sep 30, 2026.

September was the quietest month for supply this year. The float closed at **$316.2B**, up just $1.8B over thirty days, and the final week added a statistically invisible $11.2M. The gap to the $323.3B all-time high narrowed from 2.65% to 2.19% — a recovery, but a slow one.

The year-on-year number is the one to watch. Twelve months ago annual growth was running above $30B; today it is **$19.3B**. The curve that went near-vertical through 2025 has bent into a plateau, and the plateau is now nine months old.

Usage cooled with it. Average daily volume fell 13.5% to **$246.4B** and active addresses slipped 5% to 5.1M — the first month since spring in which both measures declined together. August's velocity surge, it turns out, was a spike rather than a new baseline.

Still, $246B a day moving through a $316B float means the entire supply turns over roughly every 31 hours. A cooler month in this market is still a month in which stablecoins settled more value than most national payment systems. The question for Q4 is whether new issuance — not faster circulation of old balances — restarts growth.

WHO HOLDS THE DOLLARS

TWO TOKENS STILL HOLD 82%. THE TAIL IS GETTING LONGER.

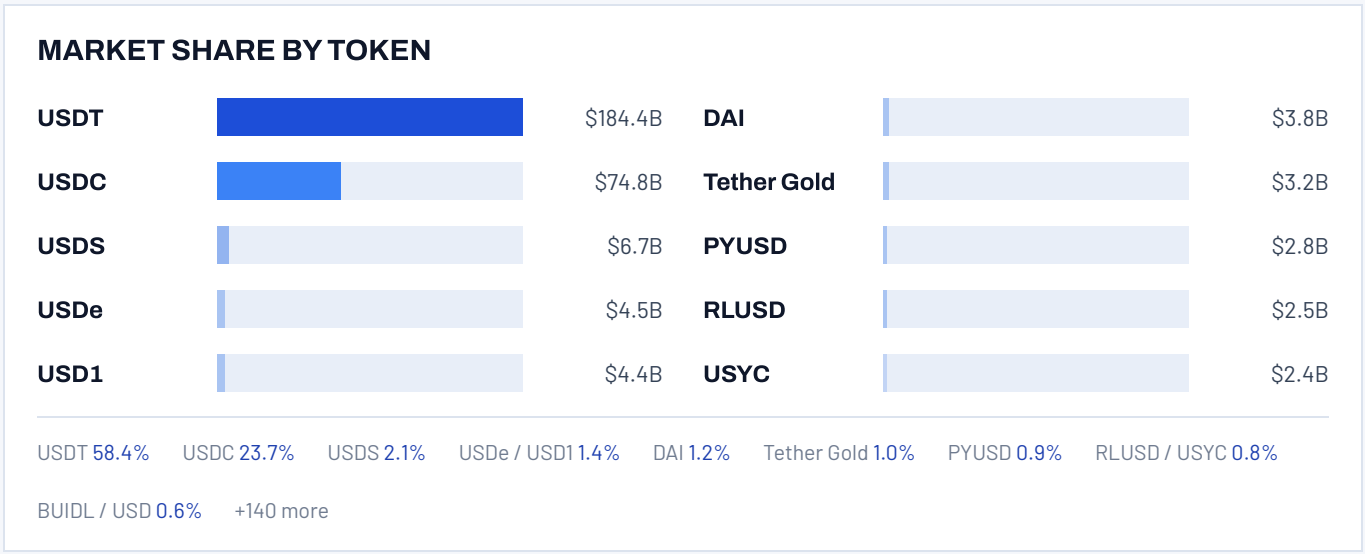


Figure 4. Bars scaled to USDT. Tokens outside the top ten hold $26.8B between them — more than USDS, USDe, USD1 and DAI combined. Source: Artemis, Sep 30, 2026.



Figure 5. USDS, USDe, USD1 and DAI in order after USDC. Daily composition barely moved; the only visible swing was a brief lift in total supply around Sep 26–28. Source: Artemis.

Tether closed September at **$184.4B** and 58.4% of the market; Circle at $74.8B and 23.7%. Combined: 82.1%, down three-tenths of a point on August. Neither leader lost ground in dollars — the rest of the market simply grew a little faster.

That growth sat in the middle tier. USDS rose to $6.7B, USDe to $4.5B and USD1 to $4.4B, while DAI held at $3.8B. Ripple's RLUSD reached $2.5B, now level with Circle's yield-bearing USYC — two very different bets, one on payments, one on treasury cash.

Gold keeps climbing the table. Tether Gold reached $3.2B and 1.0% of all stablecoin value, ahead of PYUSD. Measured by all-time net issuance, centralised venues absorbed roughly $73B of new stablecoins against about $17B for DeFi — the asset class still lives mostly on exchange balance sheets.

The long tail is the quiet story: 140 smaller tokens now hold $26.8B. None of them matters alone. Together they are the fourth-largest "issuer" in the market — and the place where bank-issued and regional stablecoins will first appear in this table.

WHERE THE DOLLARS SIT, WHERE THEY MOVE

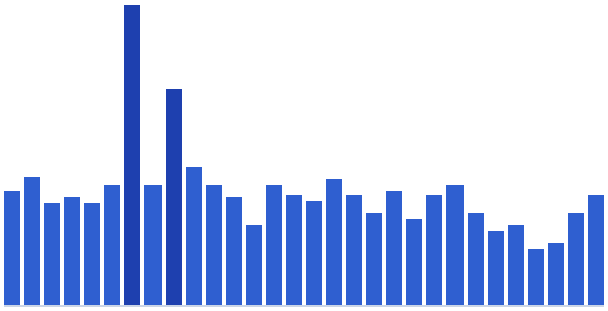
SOLANA'S TURNOVER FELL HARD. BASE KEPT THE LEAD.

SUPPLY SHARE BY CHAIN

Ethereum	$155.8B
Tron	$94.4B
Solana	5.4%
BNB Chain	5.1%
HyperEVM	2.3%
Base	1.5%
Arbitrum	1.3%
Polygon PoS	1.1%
Provenance	0.7%
Avalanche	0.5%

Ethereum 49.9% · Tron 30.2% · Stellar, Plasma 0.5% · +3 more

DAILY VOLUME · ALL CHAINS



PEAK DAY
Sep 7 · ~$670B

VOLUME LEADER
Base

Base again led daily turnover ahead of Ethereum and Tron — on 1.5% of total supply. Late-month volume sank to ~$130B a day.

Figure 6. Supply share (left) against daily settled volume (right). One outsized day on Sep 7 and a second spike on Sep 9 lifted the average; the last ten days ran well below it. Source: Artemis.

NET 30-DAY CHANGE · WHO GAINED, WHO LOST

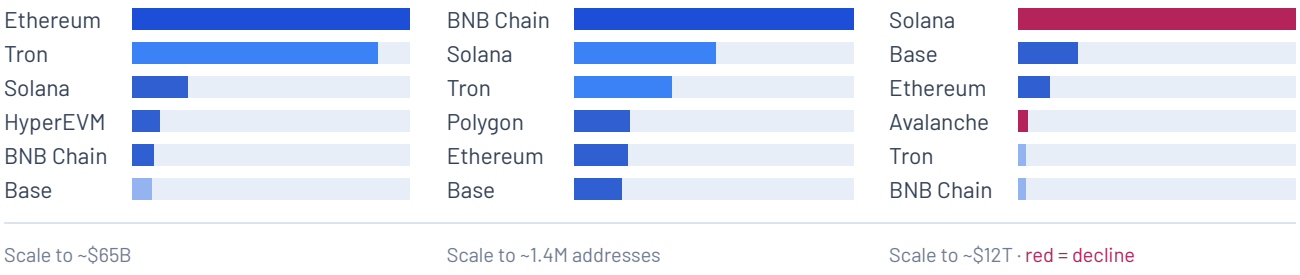


Figure 7. Ethereum and Tron took the new balances, BNB Chain the new users. On volume, Solana posted the largest decline of any chain by an order of magnitude. Source: Artemis, net change to Sep 30.

Ethereum holds **$155.8B** and Tron **$94.4B** — 80.1% of the float between them, and the two chains that absorbed most of the month's net new supply. Solana holds third at 5.4%, just ahead of BNB Chain.

The surprise was on the movement side. Solana's settled volume fell by more than any other chain's rose, even as it added the second-most active addresses: more people, smaller tickets. Base gained the most volume and, as in August, led daily turnover for most of the month. The Sep 7 spike came from Balancer and Spark flows.

LIQUIDITY AND GEOGRAPHY

BINANCE STILL CLEARS HALF. ASIA IS CATCHING EUROPE.

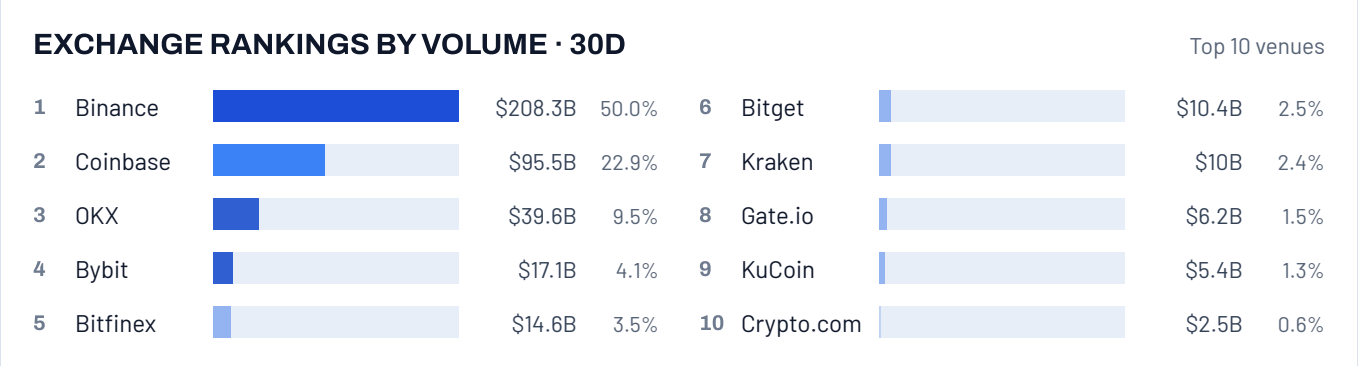
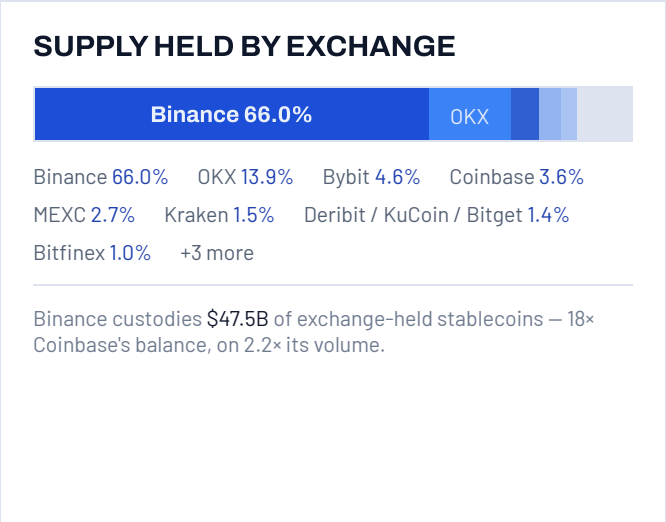


Figure 8. Binance and Coinbase clear 72.9% of exchange stablecoin volume between them, up from 71.2% in August; the next eight venues share the rest. Source: Artemis, 30 days to Sep 30, 2026.



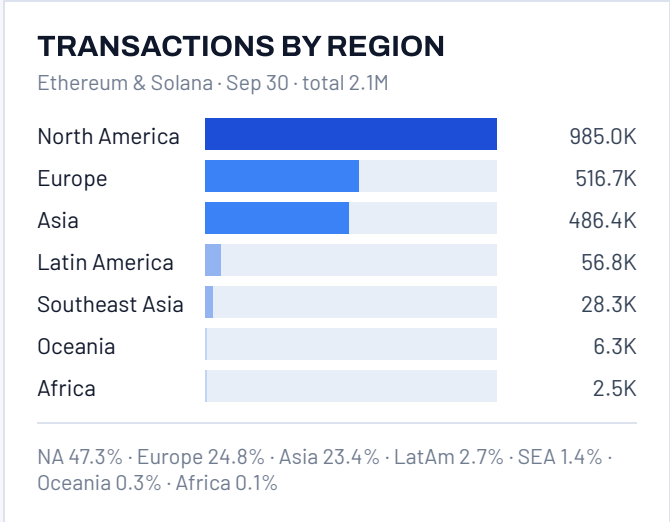


Figure 9. Custody concentration (left) and transaction geography (right). Europe started the month near 36% of transactions and finished at 24.8%; Asia rose from under 20% to 23.4%. Source: Artemis.

Venue concentration tightened again. Binance cleared **$208.3B** — exactly half of all exchange stablecoin volume — and holds 66.0% of exchange-custodied supply. Coinbase grew its volume share to 22.9% on $95.5B, yet still holds only 3.6% of balances: the venue where dollars pass through, not where they rest.

The geography moved more than anything else on these pages. North America rose to 47.3% of transactions on Ethereum and Solana, Europe fell from 35.6% to **24.8%**, and Asia climbed to 23.4% — within 30,000 daily transactions of Europe. Latin America edged up to 2.7%; Africa remains at 0.1%.

Read as a whole, September looks like a pause rather than a reversal: supply flat, turnover lower, the same issuers, chains and venues on top. What changed was where activity happens — Solana's volume fell away, Asia gained on Europe. If Q4 brings new issuance, these are the corridors it will flow through first.

THE STABLECOIN PLAYBOOK

STABLECOINS ARE NOT JUST ASSETS — THEY ARE INFRASTRUCTURE IN MOTION.
SIX LAYERS SHAPING THE NEXT GENERATION OF FINANCE.

01 **AFRICA'S STABLECOIN MAP**
Why privacy is the missing layer

02 **KOREA'S CBDC ARCHITECTURE**
The system designed around the currency

03 **THE STABLECOIN PAYMENT STACK**
Value sits between the layers

04 **JPMD MEETS USDC**
Deposit tokens and stablecoins on one rail

05 **TOKENIZED DEPOSITS**
A bank deposit, moving on a ledger

06 **AGENTIC COMMERCE**
Same checkout, new rails

IT'S NOT JUST ABOUT STABLECOINS. IT'S ABOUT THE SYSTEMS BEING BUILT AROUND THEM.

AFRICA · ECOSYSTEM MAP 2026

AFRICA'S STABLECOIN MARKET IS BIGGER THAN CRYPTO. THE MISSING LAYER IS PRIVACY.

The 2026 ecosystem map is a reminder of how many businesses now build around stablecoins — cross-border payments and business banking, on/off-ramps and liquidity, wallets and consumer products.



Seven categories, from business banking and cross-border payments to issuers, compliance and investors. Source: Settlement-Layer.

Business banking and cross-border payments is the densest corner: Onafriq, Busha Business, Juicyway, Grey Business, Bitnob, Cedar, Conduit and Damisa. On/off-ramps and liquidity bring Yellow Card, Breet, Quidax, Kotani Pay, Fonbnk, Flutterwave, StableStack and Paychant. Wallets and consumer products include Onboard, Busha, Accrue, Ejara, Verto, LemFi and KoinKoin.

Around them sits the infrastructure — stablecoin issuers, compliance providers, investors and ecosystem players. But one part of the picture is still missing from most ecosystem maps: privacy.

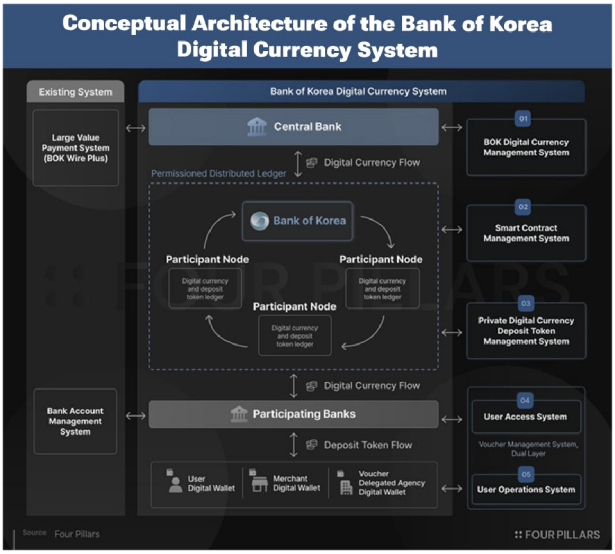
As African businesses start using stablecoins for payroll, supplier payments, remittances and cross-border settlement, transaction visibility becomes a real issue. For an individual, a payment on-chain may not seem like a big deal. For a company, a public wallet can reveal payment flows, counterparties, balances and commercial relationships.

Institutions do not need privacy to mean hiding from compliance. They need the opposite: privacy with control, auditability and regulatory visibility where required — and that matters more as stablecoins move from a crypto tool into business infrastructure.

The next phase of the African market will likely be less about who can move money on-chain, and more about who can make those transactions work safely at institutional scale.

SOUTH KOREA · CBDC ARCHITECTURE

THE CURRENCY IS THE EASY PART. THE SYSTEM AROUND IT IS THE STORY.



Central bank, permissioned ledger, participating banks and wallets, with five management systems alongside. Source: Four Pillars.

South Korea's CBDC architecture is getting more interesting — not because of the digital currency itself, but because of how the system is being designed around it.

The Bank of Korea's conceptual architecture shows something easy to miss. This is not simply a central bank issuing a digital version of cash. It is a multi-layer system connecting the central bank, participating banks, permissioned DLT, smart contracts and digital wallets.

01
Central bank
The Bank of Korea manages the digital currency system and its core functions.

02
Permissioned DLT
Participant nodes keep currency and deposit-token ledgers on a controlled network.

03
Participating banks
Connect central infrastructure to users and handle deposit-token flows.

04
Smart contracts
A management layer that opens the door to programmable transactions.

05
Digital wallets
How users, merchants and delegated agencies reach the system.

The most interesting detail is the separation between digital currency and deposit tokens. It suggests a model where CBDC infrastructure does not replace commercial banks, but becomes another layer alongside the existing banking system. That may be the bigger story.

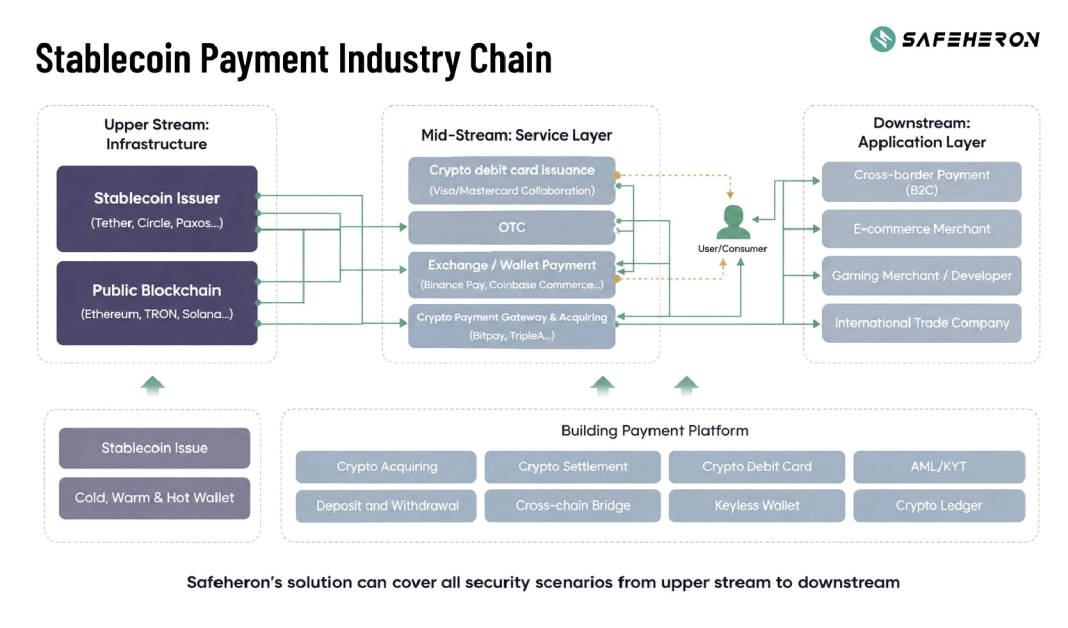
The question is moving from "should a central bank issue a CBDC?" to a more practical one: what should the financial architecture around it actually look like?

The most important CBDC experiments of the next few years will not be judged by how many people hold the token. They will be judged by what can be built on top — programmable payments, tokenized deposits and more automated financial flows. That is where the architecture gets interesting.

PAYMENTS · THE INDUSTRY CHAIN

STABLECOINS ARE NOT A PAYMENT METHOD. THEY ARE BUILDING A PAYMENT STACK.

The stablecoin itself is only the starting point. The real payment journey happens across several layers.



Upstream infrastructure, mid-stream services and downstream applications, with the payment platform underneath. Source: Safeheron.

01
Infrastructure
Issuers such as Tether, Circle and Paxos alongside Ethereum, TRON and Solana.

02
Service layer
Wallets, exchanges, OTC desks, crypto acquiring and payment gateways.

03
Payment access
Crypto cards and wallets that hide the underlying blockchain.

04
Application layer
Cross-border payments, e-commerce, gaming and international trade.

Underneath all of it sits the less glamorous but critical infrastructure: AML/KYT, custody, settlement, deposits and withdrawals, bridges and crypto ledgers. That is where the market gets interesting.

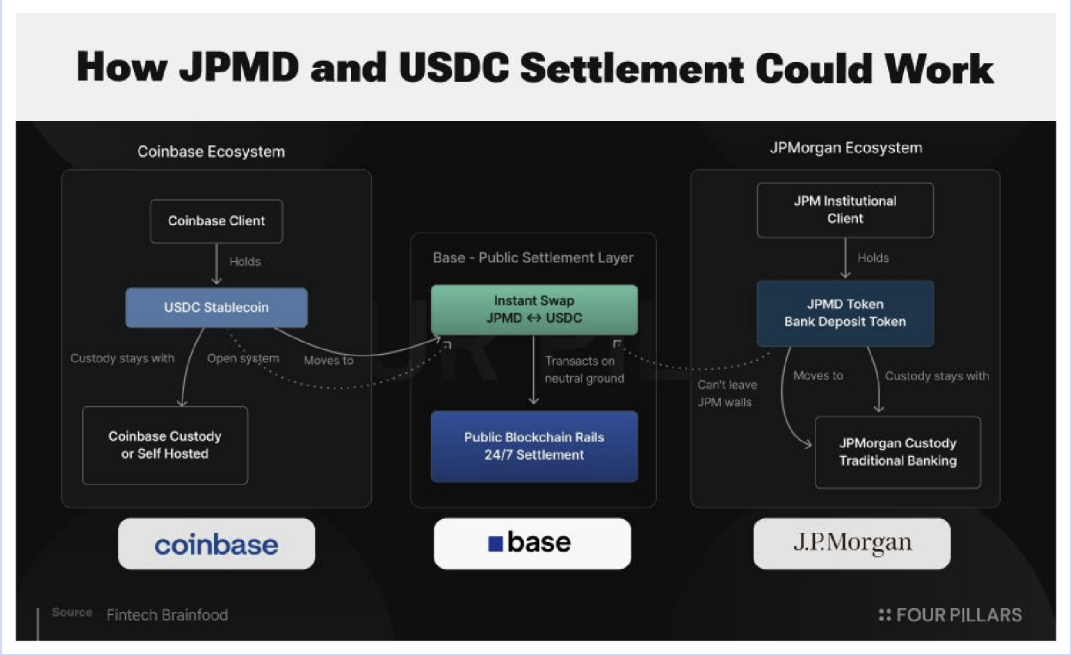
Issuing a stablecoin is one thing. Building everything around it so money can actually move is another. The question is shifting from "how do we issue and hold stablecoins?" to "how do we make them work everywhere money already moves?"

The biggest opportunities will not necessarily sit at the top of the stack. They will be in the connections between the layers — especially between the stablecoin and the payment. That middle layer could become one of the most valuable parts of the whole stack.

INTEROPERABILITY · JPMD × USDC ON BASE

WHEN A DEPOSIT TOKEN MEETS A STABLECOIN, THEY SETTLE ON NEUTRAL GROUND.

What happens when a bank deposit token and a stablecoin need to settle with each other? This diagram shows one possible answer.



A J.P. Morgan institutional client holding JPMD and a Coinbase client holding USDC meet on Base. Source: Four Pillars, via Fintech Brainfood.

JPMD
Stays at home
Remains inside JPMorgan's ecosystem and traditional custody model.

USDC
Open system
Sits with Coinbase custody or in a self-hosted wallet.

BASE
Common layer
The public chain where JPMD and USDC can be swapped.

RESULT
24/7 settlement
Between two very different forms of digital money.

Instead of forcing both sides onto the same banking system, the two assets meet on a public blockchain. That last point — round-the-clock settlement between a bank liability and a stablecoin — is the interesting one.

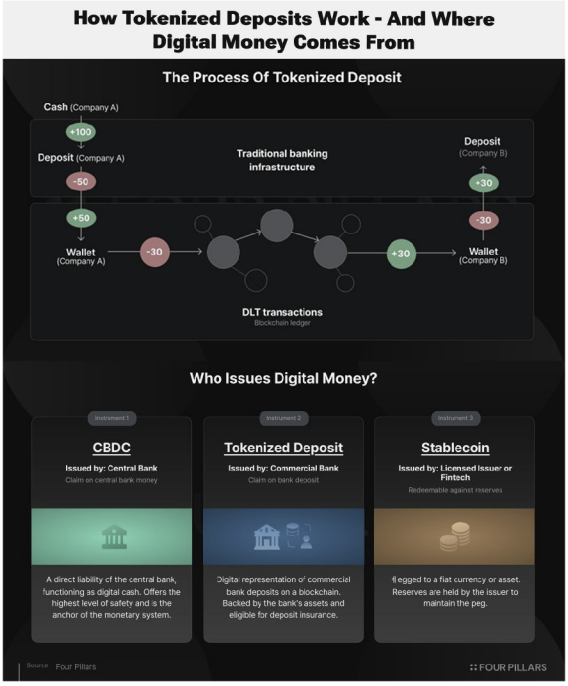
Much of the conversation has been about stablecoins replacing traditional payment rails. This points in a different direction: traditional institutions bringing their own forms of money on-chain and connecting them to existing stablecoin liquidity.

If the model works at scale, bank deposit tokens, stablecoins and other tokenized assets could move across the same settlement infrastructure without belonging to the same institution.

The next phase of tokenization will not be about choosing between bank-issued tokens and stablecoins. It will be about making them interoperable — and Base could be one of the places where that starts in practice.

BANKING · TOKENIZED DEPOSITS

SAME DEPOSIT. A DIFFERENT WAY TO MOVE IT.



The process of a tokenized deposit, and the three issuers of digital money. Source: Four Pillars.

Tokenized deposits sound more complicated than they are. Instead of moving a traditional bank deposit through the usual payment infrastructure, the bank represents that deposit as a digital token that can move on a DLT network.

The deposit. A company deposits money with its bank. The bank records the deposit and creates the corresponding tokenized representation.

The transfer. The token moves on the DLT. Company A can send value to Company B without the payment itself travelling through traditional banking rails.

The receipt. The receiving side gets the corresponding value. The underlying bank deposit still exists — the blockchain provides a different way to represent and transfer it.

CBDC
Central bank
A claim on the central bank.

TOKENIZED DEPOSIT
Commercial bank
A claim on a commercial bank.

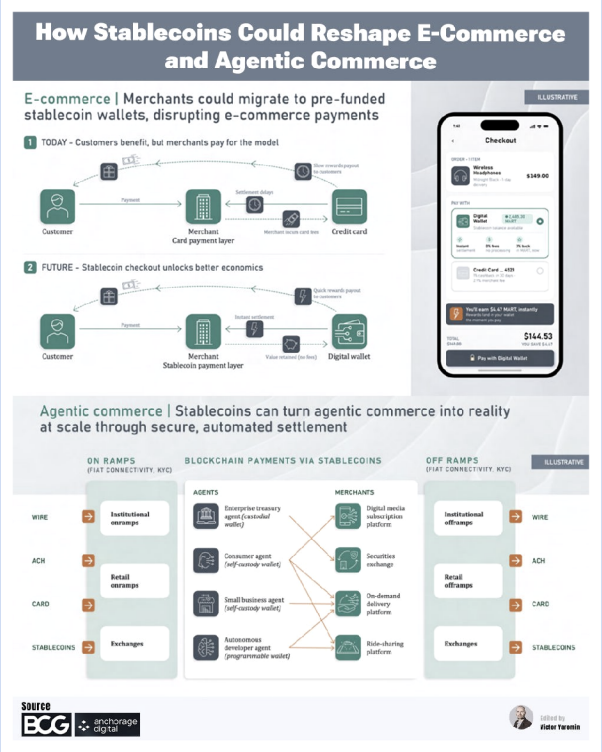
STABLECOIN
Licensed issuer or fintech
Redeemable against reserves.

The most important part of the graphic is at the bottom. CBDCs, tokenized deposits and stablecoins are not the same thing, and the distinction will matter a lot as banks start putting deposits on-chain.

Tokenized deposits will likely gain traction first in B2B payments, treasury and institutional settlement — where moving large amounts faster, with better programmability, actually solves a problem.

COMMERCE · E-COMMERCE AND AI AGENTS

THE CHECKOUT WON'T CHANGE MUCH. THE RAILS UNDERNEATH IT WILL.



Pre-funded stablecoin wallets at checkout, and AI agents paying merchants through on- and off-ramps. Source: BCG and Anchorage Digital, edited by Victor Yaromin.

The interesting part of stablecoins in commerce is not really crypto. It is what happens when the payment itself becomes part of the infrastructure.

Today a customer pays by card, the merchant waits for settlement, several intermediaries take their cut, and the whole process assumes a human initiating the payment. Stablecoins change that: merchants receive funds faster, with less friction, and potentially keep more of the transaction value.

Then there is agentic commerce. If AI agents start buying software, subscriptions, data, compute or physical goods on our behalf, the current payment model starts to look outdated. An agent needs a wallet, spending rules and a settlement rail that works automatically.

Banks still have a major role here. They are not disappearing — they become the layer connecting autonomous payments with identity, custody, compliance and the traditional financial system.

One issue deserves much more attention: privacy. For institutions, putting every transaction on a transparent public ledger is not necessarily acceptable. Banks and businesses need regulatory visibility, but they do not need every supplier payment, treasury movement or commercial relationship exposed to the entire network.

That creates the challenge: how do you make digital money transparent enough for compliance, but private enough for real business? It will be one of the defining infrastructure questions as stablecoins move deeper into banking and commerce.

Stablecoins will become less visible to consumers and far more important beneath the surface. The checkout may look exactly the same; behind it, payments become faster, programmable and increasingly autonomous.

EVENT CALENDAR

STABLECOIN CONFERENCE CALENDAR

THE MOST COMPREHENSIVE STABLECOIN CONFERENCE CALENDAR FOR 2026 AND 2027, COVERING EVENTS ACROSS NORTH AMERICA, EUROPE, ASIA, THE MIDDLE EAST AND AFRICA.

13	10	5
CONFERENCES	CITIES	REGIONS

THIRTEEN CONFERENCES. FIVE REGIONS. ONE INDUSTRY DECIDING WHO SETTLES.

NORTH AMERICA

Money20/20 USA

OCT 18–21, 2026 · THE VENETIAN, LAS VEGAS, NV

The largest fintech event in North America. Banks, payments companies and tech giants converge for four days of dealmaking around stablecoin frameworks, FedNow adoption, open banking, and the collision of crypto rails with mainstream finance.

us.money2020.com

Fintech Meetup 2027

FEB 22–24, 2027 · MANDALAY BAY, LAS VEGAS, NV

A meeting-driven event built around 50,000+ scheduled one-on-one conversations between banks, credit unions, fintechs and investors. The 2026 agenda framed stablecoins as payments infrastructure rather than speculation, with sessions on B2B and cross-border use cases.

fintechmeetup.com

Bitcoin 2027

JUL 15–17, 2027 · MUSIC CITY CENTER, NASHVILLE, TN

The world's largest Bitcoin conference returns to Nashville. Expect technical workshops on the Lightning Network, deep dives on Bitcoin Layer-2s, institutional adoption sessions, and major macro and policy keynotes.

b.tc/conference

EUROPE

MERGE Madrid 2026

OCT 27–29, 2026 · MADRID STOCK EXCHANGE & PALACIO DE CIBELES, MADRID

The European edition of MERGE, drawing 3,000+ attendees and 200+ speakers. A strong institutional lens connecting Spanish and Iberian banks, regulators and Web3 builders. Sponsors regularly include Visa, PayPal, Circle, Tether, Paxos and Bridge.

mmerge.io/merge-madrid-2026

Solana Breakpoint 2026

NOV 15–17, 2026 · OLYMPIA LONDON, LONDON, UNITED KINGDOM

Solana's flagship conference makes its London debut. Expect major ecosystem announcements, with a focused push to attract European institutional capital, family offices, and the legal infrastructure that defines global capital markets.

solana.com/breakpoint

ASIA & MIDDLE EAST

TOKEN2049 Singapore 2026

OCT 7–8, 2026 · MARINA BAY SANDS, SINGAPORE

The world's largest crypto event, taking over all five floors of Marina Bay Sands. Expect 25,000+ attendees, 300+ speakers, and broad coverage of stablecoins, RWAs and payments through the lens of regulated market infrastructure.

token2049.com/singapore

Hong Kong FinTech Week 2026

NOV 2–6, 2026 · HK CONVENTION & EXHIBITION CENTRE, HONG KONG

Asia's premier finance and technology gathering with 45,000+ attendees. The agenda covers tokenization, digital assets, programmable money rails, and Hong Kong's role as a regulated hub between East and West.

fintechweek.hk

Singapore FinTech Festival 2026

NOV 18–20, 2026 · SINGAPORE EXPO, SINGAPORE

One of the world's largest fintech gatherings, organized by the Monetary Authority of Singapore. Expect explicit programming on digital assets, tokenization, and building a new payment settlement layer with stablecoins and tokenized deposits.

fintechfestival.sg

Bitcoin MENA 2026

DEC 7–8, 2026 · ABU DHABI, UAE

The largest Bitcoin conference in the Middle East. Two days of programming on regional adoption, infrastructure and Bitcoin's role across MENA markets, headlined by global Bitcoin leaders and regional policymakers.

mena.b.tc

Abu Dhabi Finance Week 2026

DEC 7–10, 2026 · ABU DHABI, UAE

The region's flagship financial gathering, hosted by ADGM. The 2025 edition convened decision-makers representing $62 trillion in assets. Sessions span tokenization, digital assets, sovereign capital, and the architecture of trust for institutional adoption.

adfw.com

ASIA & MIDDLE EAST · CONTINUED

TOKEN2049 Dubai 2027

APR 21–22, 2027 · MADINAT JUMEIRAH, DUBAI, UAE

The Middle East edition of TOKEN2049, postponed from 2026. Expects 15,000+ attendees from 4,000+ companies and 160+ countries, with a unique indoor-outdoor format covering everything from regulation to institutional adoption to retail Web3.

token2049.com/dubai

Money20/20 Asia 2027

APR 27–29, 2027 · QUEEN SIRIKIT NATIONAL CONVENTION CENTER, BANGKOK

Asia's premier fintech event, drawing 4,000+ senior decision-makers across banking, payments, fintech and policy. The Intersection stage spotlights TradFi–DeFi convergence, while Policy20 brings central bankers and regulators into structured public-private dialogue.

asia.money2020.com

AFRICA

Africa Stablecoin Summit 2026

NOV 12–13, 2026 · JOHANNESBURG, SOUTH AFRICA

The continent's first dedicated stablecoin summit, themed "Stablecoins at Scale: Institutional Adoption & Financial Infrastructure." Built for central bank governors, commercial bank C-suites, corporate treasurers and stablecoin issuers driving Africa's digital finance buildout.

africastablecoinsummit.io

NEXT ISSUE NOVEMBER 2026

October in review: the first banks moving stablecoin settlement into limited production, and what the Q4 conference season puts on the record.

Have a report, a deal or a correction for the next edition? Send it over — contributions are credited.

WHERE STABLECOINS BECOME INFRASTRUCTURE



VIKTOR YAROMIN

EDITOR · THE STABLECOIN

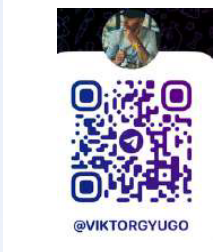
Catch the freshest features. Updated daily, read anytime, anywhere.

Contact me for any questions — reports, deals, corrections and contributions for the next issue are always welcome, and always credited.

This issue covered September 2026: banks becoming distributors, licences becoming products, and the last mile becoming the market.

MY LINKEDIN

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SCAN ME

CONTACT ME FOR ANY QUESTIONS

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